The Effect of Workload on Public Official Retention: Evidence from Local Election Officials *

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Abstract

Can reducing workloads for public officials lead to increased retention? Surveys have long shown a link between higher reported employee workloads and retirement intentions. Historic disinvestment in local, state, and federal public sectors has resulted in growing concerns that increased workloads will make finding and keeping talent even harder. These concerns are particularly acute in election administration, where recent studies have shown a sharp increase in the departures of those who run America's elections. Are heavy workloads contributing to this exodus and can election date consolidation help improve retention? Rather than relying on survey data as most prior studies of workload and retention have done, I use 11 years of national voter file data spanning 2014–2024 to calculate the yearly number of elections local election officials administer and total number of votes they process in each county, then combine this with panel data on election official turnover and employ cross-sectional, difference-in-differences, and instrumental variable designs to estimate the effect of changes in election workload on retention. I find that the workload of local election officials in the U.S. is high—with the average official overseeing 2 Election Days every single year. However, less workload does not lead to increased election official retention or better subjective evaluations of workload.

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1 Introduction

Historical long-term disinvestment in state and local government combined with increasing populations and expanding law books have resulted in growing workloads handled by fewer employees with salaries that are not keeping up with the private sector.[1] With the current administration's move to dismantle the federal bureaucracy, these concerns have now spread across all levels of government. This makes understanding how to best retain public officials more important than ever.

A large body of economics and public administration literature has found evidence for a link between manageable workloads and retention of employees, including for jobs such as teachers (Barmby 2006; Chiong, Menzies, and Parameshwaran 2017; Oke et al. 2016; Wang, Hall, and Rahimi 2015), health workers (Buykx et al. 2010; Darbyshire et al. 2021; Lock and Carrieri 2022; Pearson et al. 2006; Verma et al. 2016), police officers (Davies et al. 2024; Stotland and Pendleton 1989; Wilson et al. 2023), and even electoral management bodies (James 2019). However, these studies have almost exclusively relied on self-reported survey measures of both reported workloads and retirement intentions rather than actual administrative data on work burden and employee departures.

This paper studies the workload-retention relationship for election officials, a group of public officials that have come under particular scrutiny in recent years and for which retention is of increasing import. Turnover among election officials has been growing over the past two decades, and especially over the past few years. According to Ferrer and Thompson (2025), the four-year turnover rate of local election officials in the U.S. increased from 28% in 2004 to 41% in 2024, a 46 percent overall increase. While the recent spike in turnover may be due to a tumultuous political environment and hostility against these officials, these cannot explain the long-term growth in turnover.[2] One proposed reason for the longer-term trend is the increasing workload demands of the job over the past two decades, especially

[1] https://closup.umich.edu/sites/closup/files/2023-02/mpps-workforce-2022.pdf
[2] https://evic.reed.edu/2024-evic-leo-survey-report/

the growing complexity of administering each individual election due to population growth, technological developments, and new federal and state election laws (Ferrer, Thompson, and Orey 2024; Gronke et al. 2024).

In order to study the effect of variations in workload on retention, this paper goes beyond survey-based data by utilizing actual administrative records of workload and retention. I use over a decade of nationwide voter file data, a collection of millions of state voting records, to calculate the number of unique election dates local election officials administer each year and the number of ballots they process. I link this with data on election official turnover and use both cross-sectional and panel analyses to estimate the effect of increased workload on retention. Additionally, I use the passage of major consolidating election legislation as an exogenous instrument. I find that election officials oversee an average of 2 Election Days every single year, with some jurisdictions holding 5 Election Days a year. However, I find little evidence that reducing the number of Election Days improves the retention of local election officials. Furthermore, utilizing three nationwide surveys of election officials, I find no relationship between subjective and objective measures of election workload.

2 Why Might Fewer Election Dates Increase Election Official Retention?

The United States is an outlier in both the frequency and complexity of its elections. Unlike most countries where federal elections occur every few years, U.S. voters cast ballots at multiple levels of government—federal, state, county, municipal, and special jurisdictions—often in separate contests. Primary and runoff elections further add to the cycle, as do special elections to fill vacancies.

Academic research has long focused on the potential fatiguing effects of too many elections on voters (Boyd 1981; Franklin and Hobolt 2011; Garmann 2017; Kostelka et al. 2023; Rallings, Thrasher, and Borisyuk 2003; Schakel and Dandoy 2014). If people are asked to come to the polls too often, they are less likely to show up each time, potentially leading to unrepresentative outcomes. This is especially the case for lower-salience offices and ballot propositions, leading off-cycle local elections to produce particularly unrepresentative electorates (Anzia 2013, 2021; Berry and Gersen 2010; Hajnal and Trounstine 2005; Hajnal, Kogan, and Markarian 2022, 2024).

What has garnered less attention is the effect frequent elections have on the election officials in charge of administering them. Each election, officials are typically expected to update lists of eligible registered voters, select polling locations, recruit and train poll workers, program and test voting equipment, verify candidates' eligibility, write and print ballots, distribute resources to polling locations, communicate dates and voting rules to voters, ensure candidate compliance with electioneering and campaign finance laws, oversee Election Day voting, and tabulate and certify election results. Election officials also must administer absentee and early in-person voting, if applicable, distribute overseas and military ballots, communicate with media, and ensure all tasks are completed within budget. Additionally, each election requires officials to adhere to a vast array of federal and state laws.

Packed election schedules not only add to the stress of the job, but take time away from important duties undertaken between each election, such as registering voters and cleaning the voter rolls, attending professional trainings, recruiting and training staff and volunteer poll workers, and planning the next election to ensure a smooth, accessible experience for all eligible voters.

According to polling data from the EVIC's 2024 LEO Survey, local election officials typically report working more than 40 hours per week during peak election periods, which can last upwards of 3 months for a single Election Day.[3] In the least populous jurisdictions, the proportionate increase in the election-related work of officials during election periods is 900%, compared to their election work during non-election periods. This puts incredible strain on these officials, especially since they also typically handle non-election duties and

[3]https://evic.reed.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/2024-EVIC-LEO-Survey-Result-Report-Final-Source-File-v13.pdf

a majority of jurisdictions with less than 5,000 people have no full-time election staff. The vast majority of election officials report that their workload has increased over the past four years, both due to actual election administration duties and navigating an environment of increased public records requests and citizen complaints. These factors likely contribute to election officials' inability to leave problems at work. This evidence led the Brennan Center and Bipartisan Policy Center in a 2021 report to recommend consolidating the timing of elections so they occur concurrently rather than throughout the year.[4] The logic behind this recommendation is that election date consolidation could reduce the intense election season workloads officials reported in the EVIC/Reed College survey data.

Election date consolidation refers to the joining of separate elections together on the same date. It can take a number of forms. States can consolidate multiple levels of government into the same election, such as holding congressional, state, and county officer elections on the same date. They can also run all elections on the federal schedule, which tends to have the highest impact on voter turnout. States can reduce the number of special elections by holding these concurrently with regularly scheduled contests. Finally, states can also select alternatives to runoff elections to ensure a majoritarian outcome. Alaska, Hawaii, and Maine employ ranked choice voting for some contests, which is also known as "instant-runoff voting" for mathematically simulating what would happen in a runoff election.

Previous scholarship has uncovered a number of benefits to consolidating election dates, including increased voter turnout (Anzia 2013; Ferrer and Thorning 2023), more accountable politicians (Payson 2017), and better representation (Dynes, Hartney, and Hayes 2021; Hajnal and Trounstine 2005). Additionally, election officials have reported increasing workloads as a reason for difficulties in hiring and retention of their jobs (Manson and Gronke 2025; Roberts and Greenberger 2024). However, as with most of the broader political science and public administration literature (Ali 2019), the connection has depended on surveys asking public officials' turnover intent rather than the actual record of whether they left or not

[4] https://www.brennancenter.org/our-work/policy-solutions/election-officials-under-attack

(James 2019). Rather than relying on self-reports of workload and turnover intentions, this study relies on actual administrative records of workloads and turnover to draw its empirical conclusions.

3 Data and Methods

Virtually all previous work studying the effects of workload on turnover use survey-based measures of both workload and turnover. Employees are asked for their perceptions of how much they work and for their retirement intentions. However, there is no guarantee that one's perceptions of workload match their actual workload, nor that an intention to retire or stay on translates into what an official actually does. Case in point, Ferrer and Thompson (2025) identify substantial discrepancies between election officials' reported retirement intentions and whether they actually left their job.

This paper improves upon the link between workload and retention by using administrative data to measure the actual record of how many elections officials administered in a given year and whether officials departed their jobs.

3.1 Calculating Election Official Workload

I use two proxies for election official workload: the number of different Election Days in their jurisdiction each year, and the number of votes cast per voter age population (VAP). Both are calculated using nationwide voter file data from L2 that spans 2014 to 2024. Following best practices (Kim and Fraga 2022), I list the dates of state voter files used in Table A.2 in the online appendix. All state voter files record individual voter participation histories, indicating whether a ballot was cast by each voter on every election date in the state. The number of different Election Days captures the workload that comes with any election date, regardless of the scale of that election (high-turnout vs. low-turnout and full jurisdiction coverage vs. partial coverage). The votes cast per VAP accounts for the fact that elections with more votes cast entail more work (more polling locations and voting equipment needing setup, more poll workers needed to recruit and train, more ballots to count and certify, etc.). In effect, this proxy for workload weights each election by its turnout relative to the jurisdiction's voting-age population.

To calculate how many elections local election officials administer each year in the United States, I sum each date that votes are cast in each election jurisdiction. However, this overestimates the true number of elections administered. When people who relocate cast ballots in both their old and new jurisdictions in the same year, votes are recorded for each election date but only under the voter's most recent address. This creates false positive election dates. I use two methods to correct for movers. The first method (the "criteria" method) uses the most recent available voter file for each state for the previous year's elections, and then excludes election dates for each jurisdiction where votes cast fall below a threshold equal to the greater of 100 votes or 1% of the highest single-date total that year. The logic of this method is to identify election dates with very few votes cast relative to the highest turnout election that year and assume these are false positives from movers. If no election actually took place in the jurisdiction that year, then the threshold of 100 votes is adequate to eliminate the false appearance of elections in almost all cases. I exclude jurisdictions with populations under 1,000 residents from analysis using this method, as the 100-vote minimum threshold might eliminate legitimate low-turnout election dates in the least populated counties and municipalities. A second method (the "stayer" method) first filters the voter file to only cases where registered voters are continuously in the voter file between 2014 and 2024 and maintain the same residential address throughout that period. Then I use all voter files available for each state and count an election as occurring on a date in a jurisdiction if at least 1 vote is recorded as being cast.

Both methods result in highly correlated election workloads (r = .89), with the second method generally resulting in higher average number of election dates. I report results from the criteria method in the main descriptive analysis as it reflects a more conservative estimate of the total number of elections administered in each jurisdiction, privileging the elimination of false positives over the minimization of false negatives. Both methods are used in statistical tests to ensure the robustness of the results.[5]

I employ similar methods to calculate the total votes cast in each jurisdiction. The main votes cast measurement is identical to the criteria measure with the caveat that thresholds and criteria are not used to exclude jurisdictions or votes. I also replicate the stayer method, only counting votes from voters who have stayed in the same jurisdiction across all voters files.

There is significant variation across and within states in the degree of responsibility county election officials have for administering municipal elections. Of the 42 states with county-administered elections, county officials have substantial duties in running municipal elections in 25 of them, whereas in 11 states county officials do not play a significant role in running sub-county contests. Appendix A.1 shows a state-by-state list of the average degree of local election official authority in administering within-jurisdiction elections that take place on off-cycle dates. The main results presented do not distinguish between places with high and low municipal authority for two reasons. First, I was only able to identify municipal responsibility data at the state level. In most states, there is variation between jurisdictions in the degree of responsibility county officials have for administering municipal elections. Second, it is difficult to distinguish which elections fall into the category of local/municipal. L2 designates some elections as being "Local or Municipal" in the voter file, but it is not clear how well this captures the true nature of each election. I conduct robustness tests subsetting jurisdictions by municipal election authority.

[5]There are two additional sources of bias. One is the omission of local and special election data from some state voter files. It is not possible to correct such missing data; therefore, all numbers reported should be considered a lower threshold of the actual total election workload. A second is the right-censoring of local election data in the L2 Voter Files between 2021 and 2024. In those years, each type of off-cycle election is included in a single column rather than being separately listed by date. Therefore, off-cycle elections and votes recorded are a low threshold for the actual total election workload in those years. This limits the amount of variation in workload identifiable in those years, effectively increasing the weight of the 2014–2020 years in difference-in-differences analysis.

In addition to using the voter file to measure the number of Election Days, I manually collect data on the number of elections administered each year between 2014 and 2024 from county websites for the 400 most populous counties. In total, I was able to collect at least one year's worth of data for 353 jurisdictions and full panel data for 315 counties. The correlation between the manually collected workload data and the criteria and stayer methods from the voter file are .56 and .57, respectively. I conduct robustness tests using this data. I also conduct mechanism tests using self-reported measures of workload from the 2019, 2020, and 2023 EVIC Surveys of Local Election Officials.[6]

3.2 Data on Election Official Turnover

I use data on election official turnover from Ferrer and Thompson (2025). This data identifies the chief individual local election official who administered each even-year general election from 2000 through 2024, collected from administrative records. Table A.1 in the online appendix lists the election officials coded for each state as well as their selection method and level of jurisdiction.[7]

3.3 Estimating the Effect of Election Official Workload on Turnover

I combine my jurisdiction-year level panel dataset of yearly elections administered with panel data on election official turnover from Ferrer and Thompson (2025). I use two methods of data analysis. First, I conduct cross-sectional tests averaging workload and turnover across the years of my dataset. These tests examine whether the places where election officials administer more elections correlate with where election official turnover is higher. Second, I employ jurisdiction and state-by-year fixed effects, estimating the effect of changes in yearly Election Day workload on the probability of turnover. This estimation strategy depends on

[6] `https://evic.reed.edu/leo_survey_project/`

[7] No single individual could be identified in New York jurisdictions. Instead, the Democratic and Republican co-chairs of each county's election board were recorded. I therefore weight New York observations by half in all analysis to account for the duplicate entries.

within-county variation in the yearly number of elections administered, compared to changes in the election workload of other counties in the same state. Such variation will be driven by the incidence of special district, special, municipal, and runoff elections, some of which only involve the participation of particular jurisdictions within the same state. It will also be driven by the consolidation of off-cycle election dates and the moving of previously off-cycle contests to November general elections. I employ a wide range of different time lags to measure number of Election Days, with the primary measurement being the number of Election Days administered in the two years prior to the incidence of election official turnover (including the year of the election where turnover occurred). Finally, I identify the passage of major consolidating legislation and utilize this as a plausibly exogenous instrument that affects election official turnover only through its effect on the number of Election Days.

4 How Many Elections Do Election Officials Administer Each Year?

The average jurisdiction sees its typical chief local election official administer 1.98 elections each year.[8] This includes 1.78 federal, state, primary, special, and runoff elections, and an additional 0.2 municipal elections. Figure 1 shows the significant variation across jurisdictions, with some jurisdictions averaging fewer than 1 Election Day a year and some averaging 5 Election Days. Figure 2 shows over-time changes in the number of Election Days each year from 2014 to 2024. These within-jurisdiction changes are leveraged in the two-way fixed effect estimators. Finally, Figure 3 shows the average elections administered each year by state, breaking out those that are labeled as local or municipal by L2. As at the jurisdiction level, there is wide variation across states in terms of number of Election Dates each year, with Oklahoma officials administering over three elections per year and Wyoming

[8]The average using the stayer method is 2.2 elections per year. Figure A.2 in the online appendix shows a state-level comparison of the two methods.

administering one. Local and municipal election dates make up a significant amount of the workload in most states with above-average election date workloads, and especially in South Carolina, Louisiana, Arkansas, Missouri, and Georgia. Table A.3 and Section A.4 in the online appendix include additional descriptive statistics and analysis of the workload data, respectively.

Figure 1: **Map of Average Number of Elections Run Per Year by Local Election Officials, 2014–2024**. This figure displays the average number of yearly elections administered by each county's local election officials between 2014 and 2024, calculated using the criteria method with nationwide voter file data from L2 spanning 2014–2024. Municipal-administered districts, in gray, are in the dataset if their population is 1,000 residents or greater.

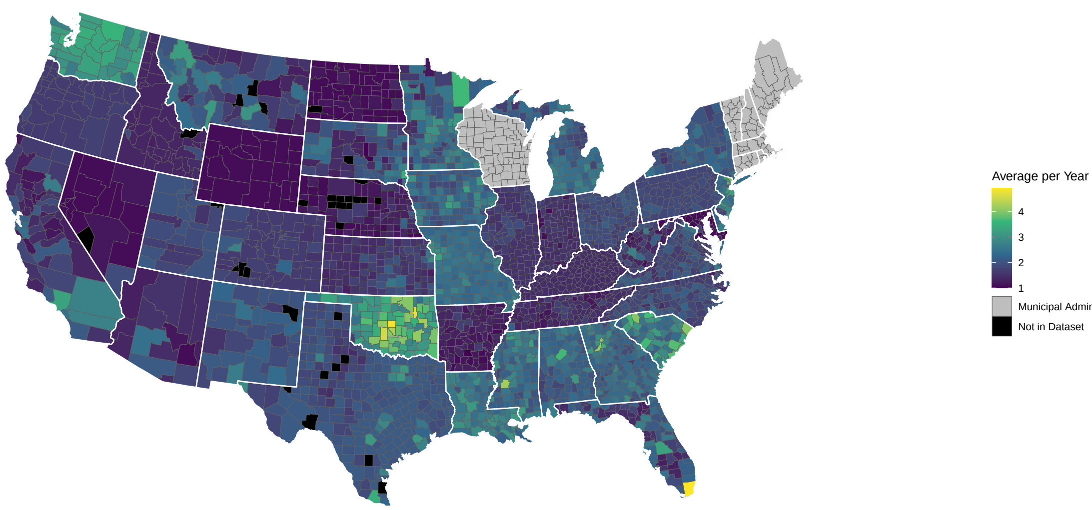


Figure 2: **Map of Elections Run Each Year, 2014–2024**. This figure displays the number of Election Days in each jurisdiction in 2014, 2016, 2022, and 2024, calculated using the criteria method with nationwide voter file data from L2. Municipal-administered districts, in gray, are in the dataset if their population is 1,000 residents or greater.

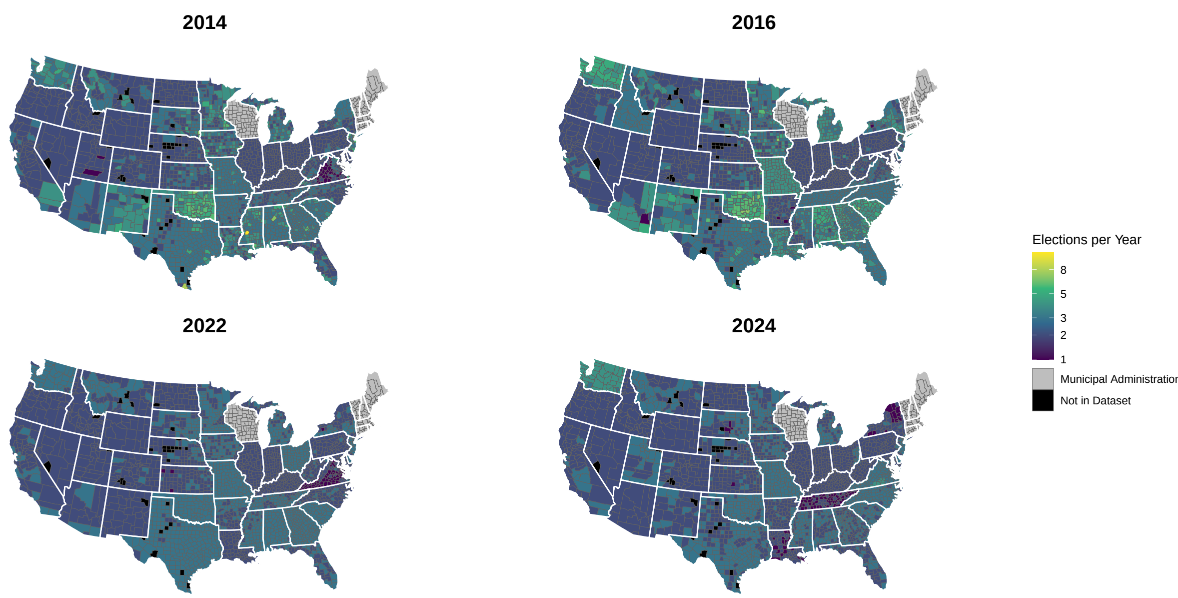
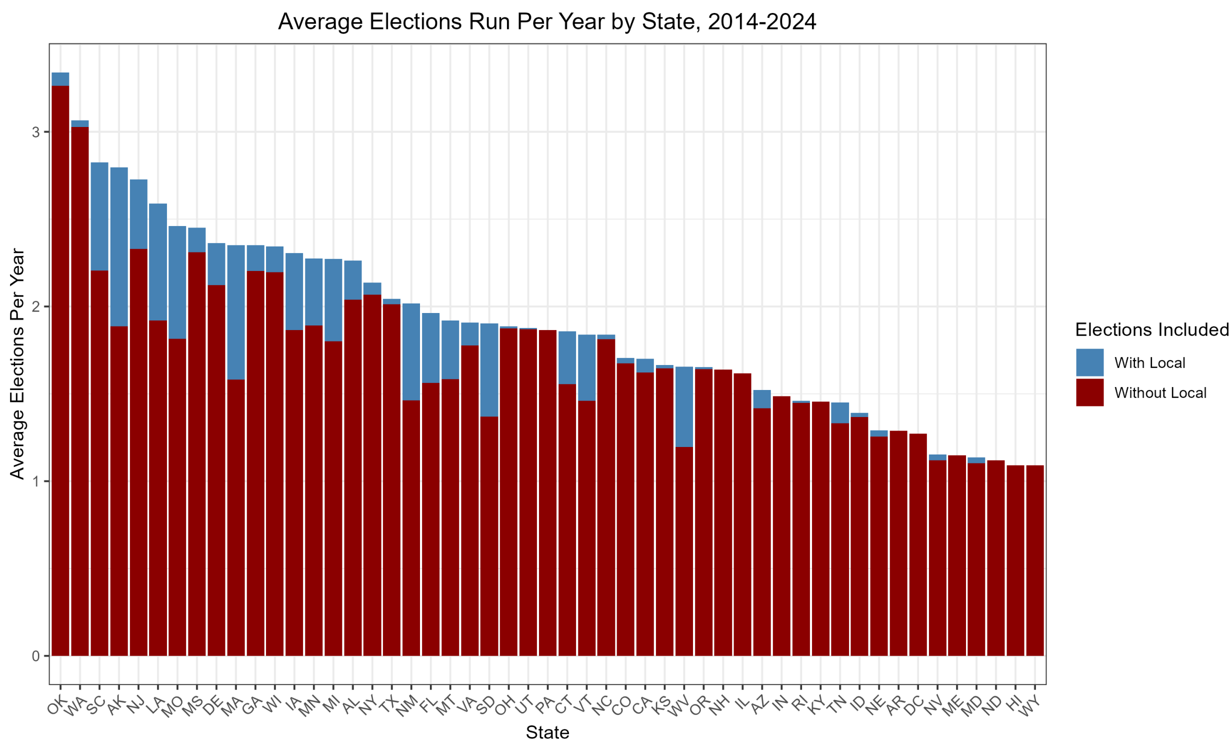


Figure 3: **Average Number of Elections Run Per Year by Local Election Officials, 2014–2024**. This figure displays the average number of elections administered each year by each state's local election officials, calculated using the criteria method with nationwide voter file data from L2 and spanning 2014–2024. The blue bars include all elections. The red bars exclude elections that are labelled as "Local_or_Municipal" by L2.



5 Effect of Election Workload on Election Official Turnover

Does reducing the number of Election Days officials administer each year or the number of ballots they process increase the retention of local election officials? I first run regressions that average across all years in the dataset to test the cross-sectional relationship between workload and turnover. I then run a series of difference-in-differences regressions testing whether a change in the number of Election Days in a year leads to a change in the likelihood that an election official leaves their position. Finally, I use the passage of legislation consolidating elections as an instrument to test the effects of workload on turnover. I find no consistent evidence that reductions in workload increase retention of election officials.

5.1 Cross-sectional Relationship between Election Workload and Turnover

Do jurisdictions that have heavier workloads tend to have higher election official turnover rates than jurisdictions with lighter workloads? Table 1 displays regression results of the relationship between more yearly Election Days and official turnover. All specifications include state fixed effects and standard errors clustered by state. This means that comparisons are made between jurisdictions in the same states. The dependent variable is the total number of different local election officials running even-year general elections between 2014 and 2024. The independent variable is the total number of Election Days in those same years. Columns 1 and 2 use the criteria method to calculate election workload, and columns 3 and 4 use the stayer method. Elections labeled as "Local or Municipal" by L2 are excluded from the calculation of election workload in columns 2 and 4. No point estimate is statistically or substantively significant. The largest point estimate, in column 2, means that jurisdictions with 10 additional non-municipal Election Days (half of a mean-sized increase) over the period of analysis had 0.1 more election officials over that same period on average. The average jurisdiction had 2 different election officials between 2014 and 2024. Table 2 uses the total number of votes cast per voting-age population as a proxy for workload. Besides this change in variable of interest, the specifications are identical to those in Table 1. Two coefficients are positive, two are negative, and none can be confidently distinguished from a null effect. The point estimate in column 1 means that 7 additional full-turnout elections (a mean-size increase over 11 years) raises the total number of local election officials administering the 6 federal elections by .027—again a tiny effect compared to a mean of 2 election officials.

Table 1: **Relationship Between Election Workload and Turnover, 2014–2024**

	Total Number of Local Election Officials			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Total Elections Administered	0.003	0.010	0.001	0.003
	(0.006)	(0.007)	(0.003)	(0.004)
States	50	50	50	50
Observations	5,082	5,082	6,259	6,259
Outcome Mean	2.04	2.04	2.03	2.03
State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by state in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction, 2014–2024.

Tables A.4 and A.5 in the online appendix test the robustness of these results to the dropping of state fixed effects. This means that comparisons are made between jurisdictions across the entire country, not just within the same state. The point estimates are scattered around zero and show there is no relationship between more Election Days and higher election official turnover rates.

5.2 Difference-in-Differences Tests of the Effect of Election Workload on Turnover

This section examines the causal effect of additional Election Days and ballots processed in preceding years on the likelihood of chief local election official turnover. Table 3 shows

Table 2: **Relationship Between Election Workload and Turnover, 2014–2024**

	Total Number of Local Election Officials			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Total Votes Per VAP	0.004	0.006	-0.011	-0.011
	(0.013)	(0.012)	(0.006)	(0.006)
States	49	49	49	49
Observations	6,248	6,248	6,199	6,199
Outcome Mean	2.03	2.03	2.04	2.04
State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by state in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction, 2014–2024. Jurisdictions where voting-age population is unavailable are excluded from votes-per-VAP specifications.

the effect of changes in the number of elections administered over the past two years on the two-year turnover rate. The "past two years" are defined as including the even-year general election which measures a change in turnover. All specifications include jurisdiction and Year x State fixed effects, meaning comparisons are only made between jurisdictions within the same state. Columns 1 and 2 use the criteria method to measure workload, whereas columns 3 and 4 use the stayer method. Odd columns include L2-defined "local and municipal" elections, and even columns exclude them. The point estimate in column 1 means that an additional Election Day over the past 2 years (one-fourth of the mean) decreases the likelihood that there is a new election official by 0.3 percentage points. This is small in comparison to the average 2-year turnover rate of 21%. All four point estimates are negative, indicating that higher election workloads lead to increased election official retention. None can be distinguished from a null effect at conventional confidence levels. These point estimates are precisely estimated. Using the most positive specification (column 2), I can confidently rule out effects larger than an increase in turnover of 0.8 percentage points for each additional election date administered over the prior two years.

Table 3: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered over Past 2 Years	-0.003	-0.002	-0.005	-0.005
	(0.004)	(0.005)	(0.003)	(0.004)
Jurisdictions	5,082	5,082	6,263	6,263
Years	5	5	5	5
Observations	25,410	25,410	31,303	31,303
Outcome Mean	0.21	0.21	0.21	0.21
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table 4 presents similar specifications, but instead measures workload as the average number of votes cast per voting-age population. Again, the point estimates indicate, if anything, that higher workloads increase retention. The point estimate in column 1 means that one additional full-turnout election over a 2-year period (a near mean-sized increase) reduces the likelihood of election official turnover by 2.6 percentage points.

5.3 The Main Result of A Null Effect of Election Workload on Turnover Is Robust Across Specifications

These null results are robust to a wide range of alternative specifications, including varying the definitions of turnover and workload, varying the level of clustering, subsetting to the places that we would most likely expect an effect, testing across temporal changes to the L2 voter file data, and using alternative methods to collect workload data, which are displayed in the online appendix. Table A.9 measures workload over a four-year period rather than a two-year period. The point estimates are all close to 0 and are not statistically distinguishable from a null result. Table A.10 changes the measurement of workload to be the two prior

Table 4: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024 (Measured by Votes Cast)**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Votes Per VAP over Past 2 Years	-0.026	-0.023	0.000	0.001
	(0.016)	(0.017)	(0.028)	(0.030)
Jurisdictions	6,250	6,250	6,204	6,204
Years	5	5	5	5
Observations	31,247	31,247	31,007	31,007
Outcome Mean	0.21	0.21	0.21	0.21
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024. Jurisdictions where voting-age population is unavailable are excluded from votes-per-VAP specifications.

years of Election Dates, not counting the year in which turnover is measured. Table A.11 instead measures workload as the two years of Election Dates prior to the two-year period in which turnover is measured (effectively the third and fourth lagged years). In both tables, all point estimates are again statistically indistinguishable from zero. Table A.12 subsets to jurisdictions in states with a high degree of responsibility for administering local/municipal elections; Table A.13 subsets to jurisdictions where the coded election official has most or all election-related responsibilities, using the coding scheme from Ferrer and Thompson (2025); and Table A.14 subsets the data to county-administered election jurisdictions, cutting out all municipal-administered jurisdictions. Again, all point estimates are small and statistically indistinguishable from a null effect.

Tables A.15 and A.16 employ year fixed effects instead of year-by-state fixed effects, allowing comparisons between jurisdictions in different states. All point estimates are positive in these specifications, and they attain conventional levels of statistical significance in six of eight specifications ($p < .05$). The largest effect size, found in column 2 of Table A.15, means that 1 additional election date over a 2-year period (compared to an average of 3.6 non-local elections) translates to a 1.5 percentage point increase in the likelihood of turnover. Compared with an average turnover rate of 21%, this translates into a 7.1% increase in the likelihood of turnover. However, these specifications are the most susceptible to bias due to state-specific turnover shocks. Table A.17 tests the effects of workload collected through examining websites of the 400 most populous counties for data on the number of Election Dates each year. Three of the point estimates are negative—and one of them attains conventional levels of statistical significance. Although this is a relatively small sample of counties, the manual data is likely higher in quality, lending additional credibility to a null result.

Table A.6 includes a placebo test of the effect of future election workload on current turnover, clustering standard errors by state rather than jurisdiction, and testing the effects of election workload separately for the 2016–2020 and 2022–2024 periods due to a change in how L2 records off-cycle elections in 2021. All results are statistically indistinguishable from zero. Table A.7 examines lagged effects of increased workload. The point estimates are positive, but the joint Wald test of significance is p = 0.58. Finally, Table A.8 bins the number of Election Days rather than treating it as continuous. Again, I find no evidence that administering more Election Days increase turnover of election officials.

In sum, across regressions varying the method of workload calculation, the number of years used to calculate workload, the definition of turnover as two or four years, the inclusion or exclusion of local elections, and lags employed, I find evidence consistent with there being minimal effects of number of Election Days administered on retention of local election officials. There is roughly an equal number of tests that result in positive and negative point estimates. Most are statistically indistinguishable from zero. While six tests do result in a statistically significant positive relationship, one results in a significant relationship in the opposite direction. The largest positive relationship between workload and turnover—an additional election date over a two-year period leading to a 7.1% increase in the likelihood of turnover—while in isolation might be suggestive of an effect, could easily arise by chance given the large number of tests performed. Additionally, the most positive effects were identified in the less causally credible specifications, where differential trending by states could be responsible for the effect. Therefore, I conclude that there is little evidence that the number of Election Days or the number of votes cast (relative to the voting-age population) affect the likelihood that a chief election official will stay in their role.

5.4 Major Consolidating Legislation Does Not Affect Number of Elections Administered or Election Official Turnover

Do election officials stick around longer after a state passes major consolidating election reforms? The passage of election laws that consolidate election dates should be exogenous to election official turnover rates, except via their impact on the number of Election Days administered. This will be true so long as increasing election official turnover rates and the concerns of election officials themselves were not the main motivators of the timing of such laws. While the opinions of election officials may play some role in the determination of election consolidation policy, the major motivating factors are voter attention, voter turnout, and cost savings.[9] Therefore, I treat the passage of such laws as a natural experiment and use them as an instrument that impacts election official turnover only through their impact on the number of Election Days administered.

I identify the timing of major consolidating laws implemented by states between 2014 and 2023. I identify eight laws passed in seven states that should have a substantial effect on the number of Election Days. These laws are displayed in Table A.18. The treated year is the first full year after the legislation is effective, except for legislation effective on January 1 of a year in which case it first coded for that year, and is an absorbing indicator. Arizona is excluded from regressions since it is always treated, with major consolidating legislation

[9] https://www.ncsl.org/state-legislatures-news/details/a-move-toward-fewer-elections-with-more-on-the-ballots

effective in 2014. Oklahoma passed two major consolidating laws in this period, and is considered treated after the implementation of the first law.

Table 5 shows the results of a 2SLS regression. Column 1 shows the first stage, with the number of elections administered regressed on the implementation of a major consolidating law. This tests whether the laws actually reduced the number of Election Days. Column 2 shows the reduced form, with election official turnover regressed on the implementation of an election consolidation law. Column 3 shows a similar OLS specification displayed in column 1 of Table A.15, with standard errors clustered by state instead of jurisdiction. Finally, Column 4 shows the 2SLS specification.

Table 5: Election consolidation legislation, elections administered, and local election official turnover

	(1) First stage	(2) Reduced form	(3) OLS	(4) 2SLS
Consolidation law in effect	-0.083	-0.009		
	(0.406)	(0.020)		
Elections administered			0.008	0.102
			(0.004)	(0.426)
Jurisdictions	5,067	5,067	5,067	5,067
Years	5	5	5	5
Observations	25,335	25,335	25,335	25,335
Dependent variable	Elections	Turnover	Turnover	Turnover
Mean of dep. variable	3.83	0.213	0.213	0.213
Jurisdiction FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Panel of local election jurisdictions across 49 states. Six states adopt major election consolidation legislation within the panel window (OK 2016, CA 2018, LA 2020, NV 2022, ID 2024, TX 2024); treatment is coded as an absorbing indicator equal to one in the first full year the law is in effect. AZ enacted major election consolidation legislation that took effect in 2014, and so is excluded. Standard errors clustered by state in parentheses.

The point estimate in Column 1 is negative, but is not statistically significant. It is also small relative to the mean: consolidating election legislation reduces the average number of elections by 0.08, a 2 percent reduction in elections. This means consolidating election laws are too weak of an instrument to reliably measure the effect of reducing Election Days on election official turnover. Column 2 shows the implementation of consolidating election laws has no discernible effect on election official turnover. The 2SLS specification returns a much larger point estimate than the naive OLS regression, but the weakness of the instrument results in a very imprecise estimation that has little empirical value. As with the cross-sectional and difference-in-differences specifications, I am unable to identify any relationship between number of Election Days and election official turnover.

6 Election Officials Self-Reported Workload Does Not Match Objective Measures of Workload

Why is there no relationship between objective measures of election workload and election official turnover? One potential mechanism is the translation of objective measures of workload into subjective ones. Perhaps more Election Days to arrange or more votes to process leads to increased subjective reports of workload, which then fail to induce turnover for some reason. Alternatively, objective measures of workload could fail to translate into subjective measures of workload altogether.

In order to test this possibility, I merge survey data of election official attitudes from the 2019, 2020, and 2023 EVIC Surveys of Local Election Officials with my jurisdiction-year panel data on election workload. Table 6 shows two series of regressions: Panel A includes year fixed effects and thus tests the cross-sectional relationship between election frequency and subjective measures of workload, and Panel B includes year and jurisdiction fixed effects, testing the effect of an increase in election frequency on the attitudes of election officials in jurisdictions sampled multiple times across surveys. Column 1 tests the question "My Workload is reasonable", column 2 tests agreement with "I can't balance work and home priorities", column 3 tests whether "Lack of funding prevents doing my job well", column 4 tests the number of Full-Time Equivalents, column 5 tests whether "My work gives me a feeling of personal accomplishment", and column 6 tests agreement with "It is part of my job to encourage voter turnout." Across all questions, I find a null effect of Election Day frequency on election official's subjective reports of workload. These results hold in both cross-sectional and two-way fixed effects specifications, as well as with using votes per VAP as the objective measure of workload (found in Table A.19).

Table 6: **Election Frequency and Local Election Official Attitudes**

	Workload reasonable (1)	Cannot balance (2)	Lack of funding (3)	FTEs (4)	Sense of accomplish (5)	Job turnout (6)
Panel A: Year fixed effects						
Elections over Past 2 Years	0.023	0.000	-0.005	0.072	0.013	-0.037
	(0.022)	(0.020)	(0.022)	(0.128)	(0.012)	(0.022)
Panel B: Year and jurisdiction fixed effects						
Elections over Past 2 Years	0.009	0.006	0.043	-0.186	-0.010	-0.007
	(0.039)	(0.036)	(0.040)	(0.207)	(0.024)	(0.044)
Jurisdictions	1,318	1,321	1,318	1,312	1,222	1,240
Years	3	3	3	3	3	3
Observations	1,850	1,853	1,853	1,845	1,673	1,688
Outcome Mean	3.12	2.56	2.76	6.21	4.52	3.80

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. Data are the 2019, 2020, and 2023 EVIC Survey of Local Election Officials, merged to the jurisdiction-year panel. Individual controls are the total number of registered voters in the election jurisdiction and the age, gender, race, education, and salary of the election official. Columns 1–3 and 5–6 are 1–5 Likert scales ranging from "strongly disagree" to "strongly agree"; column 4 measures full-time equivalents.

In sum, objective measures of workload do not obviously translate into subjective measures of workload. It therefore makes sense that fewer Election Days or ballots to process does not obviously lead to increased election official retention.

7 Conclusion

While it may seem like commonsense that heavier workloads will result in burnout and shorter tenures for public officials, most studies of the relationship have relied on surveys that are rife with the potential for misreporting and intentions that do not translate into reality. Using a novel strategy to translate administrative data on voting records into the record of Election Dates and a massive collection of administrative data on chief local election officials, I find little evidence that higher workloads, proxied by more Election Dates and more votes cast, lead to earlier departures of those running America's elections. Across a wide range of robustness tests, I consistently find that workloads appear to have little effect on the likelihood that an election official will stay in their job for the next major election. Additionally, I find that legislation aimed at consolidating election dates does not clearly achieve fewer Election Days, and that objective measures of election workload do not map onto subjective ones for election officials.

This paper has important implications for the field of election administration. Turnover rates have increased precipitously over the past two decades (Ferrer, Thompson, and Orey 2024). While it appears this has not resulted in worse quality of election administration (Ferrer and Thompson 2025), there are legitimate concerns that increased turnover portends increasing difficulty in finding and keeping quality election administrators. Job satisfaction among local election officials has dropped 14 percentage points since the 2020 election, with increasing workloads cited as one of the main drivers of this decline.[10] While reducing the number of separate elections may cut costs and make the voting process more convenient for the public, in addition to other benefits, it does not have an effect on increasing retention of local election officials. Reformers interested in increasing election official retention should look to other promising strategies, such as increasing salaries, professionalization opportunities, and public awareness of the work these public servants undertake—at least when it comes to those leading election offices.

It is important to note that election officials are not the only government employees reporting increasing workload concerns. While this study tests the relationship between workload and turnover for one public office, it could still be the case that increasing workloads in government contribute to higher turnover rates for other offices. More work is needed to understand the potential dangers of increasing public workloads, especially in an era of

[10] https://evic.reed.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/2024-EVIC-LEO-Survey-Result-Report-Final-Source-File-v13.pdf

government retrenchment and mass layoffs. The ability of America's government to serve its residents depends on the presence of qualified public servants willing to work for low pay and long hours to serve the common good. It is imperative we better understand the limits of this ask.

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Online Appendix

Intended for online publication only.

Contents

A.1 Collection and Coding of Local Election Officials

Table A.1 lists the election officials used in each state, as well as their geography, selection method, and typical degree of responsibility for administering municipal elections. Whether there is variation in this responsibility within each state is also noted.

Table A.1: **Local Election Official Responsibility for Off-Cycle Municipal Elections by State**

State	Jurisdictions	Geography	Election Official	Selection Method	Muni Responsibility	Variation
Alabama	67	County	Probate Judge	Elected	Med	No
Alaska	5	Region	Regional Election Supervisor	Appointed	Low	No
Arizona	15	County	County Election Administrator / County Recorder	Mixed	Med	Yes
Arkansas	75	County	Clerk	Elected	Med	Yes
California	58	County	Clerk / Registrar of Voters / Auditor / Director of Elections	Mixed	Med	Yes
Colorado	64	County	Clerk and Recorder	Mixed	Low	Yes
Connecticut	178	Municipal	Clerk	Mixed	High	No
Delaware	3	County	Director of Elections	Appointed	Low	No
Florida	67	County	Supervisor of Elections	Mixed	High	No
Georgia	159	County	Elections Director / Probate Judge	Mixed	Low	No
Hawaii	5	County	Clerk	Appointed	Low	No
Idaho	44	County	Clerk	Elected	High	No
Illinois	102	County	Clerk / Executive Director	Mixed	High	Yes
Indiana	92	County	Clerk	Elected	High	Yes
Iowa	99	County	Auditor	Elected	High	No
Kansas	105	County	Clerk	Mixed	High	No
Kentucky	120	County	Clerk	Elected	High	No
Louisiana	64	Parish	Clerk of Court	Elected	High	No
Maine	504	Municipal	Clerk	Mixed	Low	No
Maryland	24	County	Election Director	Appointed	High	No
Massachusetts	351	Municipal	Clerk / Elections Commissioner	Mixed	Low	No
Michigan	83	County	Clerk	Elected	Low	Yes
Minnesota	87	County	Auditor / Election Director	Mixed	Low	No
Mississippi	82	County	Circuit Clerk	Elected	High	No
Missouri	115	County	Clerk / Director of Elections	Elected	High	No
Montana	56	County	Clerk and Recorder / Election Administrator	Mixed	High	Yes
Nebraska	93	County	Clerk / Election Commissioner	Mixed	Med	No
Nevada	17	County	Clerk / Registrar of Voters	Mixed	High	No
New Hampshire	234	Municipal	Clerk	Mixed	High	No
New Jersey	21	County	Clerk	Elected	High	Yes
New Mexico	33	County	Clerk	Elected	Low	Yes
New York	62	County	Election Commissioner	Appointed	High	No
North Carolina	100	County	Election Director	Appointed	Low	Yes
North Dakota	53	County	Auditor	Elected	High	No
Ohio	88	County	County Election Director	Appointed	Low	Yes
Oklahoma	77	County	Election Board Secretary	Appointed	High	No
Oregon	36	County	Clerk / Elections Director	Mixed	Low	Yes
Pennsylvania	67	County	Director of Elections	Appointed	High	No
Rhode Island	39	Municipal	Clerk / Registrar / Election Director	Mixed	High	No
South Carolina	46	County	Director of Voter Registration and Elections	Appointed	High	No
South Dakota	66	County	Auditor	Mixed	High	Yes
Tennessee	95	County	Administrator of Elections	Appointed	Med	Yes
Texas	254	County	Elections Administrator / Clerk / Tax Assessor	Mixed	High	No
Utah	29	County	Clerk	Elected	Low	Yes
Vermont	246	Municipal	Clerk	Mixed	Low	Yes
Virginia	133	County	General Registrar	Appointed	High	No
Washington	39	County	Auditor / Elections Director	Elected	High	No
West Virginia	55	County	Clerk / Elections Coordinator	Mixed	High	No
Wisconsin	1851	Municipal	Clerk	Mixed	Med	Yes
Wyoming	23	County	Clerk	Elected	High	No

Number of jurisdictions are total number of jurisdictions in that state. In states where multiple officials are coded, a '/' separates each distinct official and they are listed in order by frequency. In the turnover dataset, the official in each jurisdiction with primary authority to administer elections is coded, especially those who oversee voting administration on Election Day. Selection method indicates whether all officials coded in each state are elected, appointed, or a mix of both. Muni Responsibility indicates the degree of responsibility the local election official has in administering off-cycle municipal elections. Variation indicates whether jurisdictions within the state vary according to their degree of responsibility in administering off-cycle municipal elections. In states with variation, the modal degree of responsibility is used.

A.2 L2 Voter File Dates Used

Table A.2 lists the dates of each L2 state voter file used, as per best practices (Kim and Fraga 2022).

Table A.2: L2 Voter File Dates Used

State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date
AK	4/18/2014	AK	3/13/2015	AK	7/28/2015	AK	8/26/2015
AK	12/9/2015	AK	2/9/2016	AK	5/21/2016	AK	6/22/2016
AK	9/23/2016	AK	1/27/2017	AK	5/25/2017	AK	8/15/2018
AK	10/2/2018	AK	2/11/2019	AK	5/3/2019	AK	7/2/2019
AK	2/24/2020	AK	8/14/2020	AK	10/9/2020	AK	2/3/2021
AK	7/4/2021	AK	11/3/2021	AK	11/24/2021	AK	12/1/2022
AK	4/8/2023	AK	12/3/2024	AK	2/14/2025	AL	3/18/2014
AL	4/10/2015	AL	7/29/2015	AL	10/14/2015	AL	12/9/2015
AL	1/24/2016	AL	9/23/2016	AL	3/7/2017	AL	6/13/2017
AL	11/1/2017	AL	7/7/2018	AL	1/27/2019	AL	5/16/2019
AL	6/12/2019	AL	8/27/2019	AL	2/17/2020	AL	2/24/2020
AL	4/10/2020	AL	8/14/2020	AL	10/9/2020	AL	2/4/2021
AL	2/24/2021	AL	7/5/2021	AL	11/3/2021	AL	11/14/2021
AL	11/15/2022	AL	6/14/2023	AL	12/3/2024	AL	10/7/2025
AR	4/11/2014	AR	3/24/2015	AR	7/28/2015	AR	8/31/2015
AR	3/15/2016	AR	5/26/2016	AR	9/23/2016	AR	3/29/2017
AR	7/5/2017	AR	1/30/2018	AR	9/1/2018	AR	9/20/2018
AR	4/12/2019	AR	5/13/2019	AR	9/21/2019	AR	2/7/2020
AR	2/24/2020	AR	4/11/2020	AR	7/30/2020	AR	3/16/2021
AR	11/3/2021	AR	11/15/2022	AR	8/29/2023	AR	10/2/2024
AR	6/20/2025	AZ	3/14/2014	AZ	4/22/2015	AZ	7/28/2015
AZ	10/3/2016	AZ	4/12/2017	AZ	8/26/2017	AZ	10/24/2017
AZ	8/27/2018	AZ	5/8/2019	AZ	5/10/2019	AZ	10/21/2019
AZ	2/19/2020	AZ	6/16/2020	AZ	10/1/2020	AZ	10/23/2020
AZ	1/13/2021	AZ	5/20/2021	AZ	7/5/2021	AZ	11/3/2021
AZ	10/8/2022	AZ	3/18/2023	AZ	6/26/2024	AZ	11/27/2024
AZ	3/4/2025	CA	3/21/2014	CA	1/29/2015	CA	5/21/2015
CA	9/29/2016	CA	3/25/2017	CA	7/8/2017	CA	8/17/2018
CA	1/31/2019	CA	8/2/2019	CA	7/2/2020	CA	12/5/2020
CA	8/24/2021	CA	12/17/2022	CA	6/26/2024	CA	1/10/2025
CO	5/5/2014	CO	5/5/2015	CO	7/28/2015	CO	1/30/2016
State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date

State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date
CO	10/13/2016	CO	12/15/2016	CO	2/8/2017	CO	6/1/2017
CO	12/27/2017	CO	8/8/2018	CO	12/20/2018	CO	5/8/2019
CO	8/31/2019	CO	1/23/2020	CO	2/26/2020	CO	4/23/2020
CO	5/10/2020	CO	6/24/2020	CO	8/24/2020	CO	10/30/2020
CO	12/23/2020	CO	5/28/2021	CO	7/5/2021	CO	11/3/2021
CO	12/7/2022	CO	1/14/2023	CO	6/26/2024	CO	1/10/2025
CO	1/15/2025	CT	3/14/2014	CT	3/25/2015	CT	7/28/2015
CT	8/17/2015	CT	3/9/2016	CT	9/23/2016	CT	1/20/2017
CT	6/9/2017	CT	8/27/2018	CT	3/6/2019	CT	5/8/2019
CT	6/3/2019	CT	2/21/2020	CT	8/14/2020	CT	10/13/2020
CT	3/30/2021	CT	7/13/2021	CT	12/14/2022	CT	5/24/2023
CT	2/20/2025	CT	7/31/2025	DC	3/14/2014	DC	3/7/2015
DC	7/28/2015	DC	3/1/2016	DC	9/23/2016	DC	2/15/2017
DC	6/19/2017	DC	3/1/2018	DC	1/17/2019	DC	5/3/2019
DC	6/5/2019	DC	1/13/2020	DC	3/2/2020	DC	4/30/2020
DC	7/30/2020	DC	10/1/2020	DC	1/30/2021	DC	7/5/2021
DC	9/21/2022	DC	9/18/2023	DC	1/10/2025	DC	6/4/2025
DE	3/20/2014	DE	2/23/2015	DE	8/18/2015	DE	6/18/2016
DE	9/23/2016	DE	1/17/2017	DE	1/11/2018	DE	8/18/2018
DE	10/12/2018	DE	4/2/2019	DE	5/10/2019	DE	10/3/2019
DE	2/16/2020	DE	8/14/2020	DE	10/1/2020	DE	10/23/2020
DE	3/24/2021	DE	7/5/2021	DE	11/3/2021	DE	10/26/2022
DE	5/20/2023	DE	5/10/2025	FL	3/17/2014	FL	1/28/2015
FL	5/16/2015	FL	3/1/2016	FL	6/14/2016	FL	1/27/2017
FL	3/6/2017	FL	8/2/2018	FL	2/8/2019	FL	7/4/2019
FL	7/30/2020	FL	10/1/2020	FL	2/4/2021	FL	7/20/2021
FL	2/9/2023	FL	6/26/2024	FL	10/18/2024	FL	2/11/2025
GA	4/20/2014	GA	5/16/2015	GA	9/1/2015	GA	7/8/2016
GA	9/23/2016	GA	1/26/2017	GA	8/16/2017	GA	7/5/2018
GA	6/11/2019	GA	7/24/2020	GA	7/16/2021	GA	8/27/2022
GA	12/5/2022	GA	6/26/2024	GA	9/5/2024	GA	12/24/2024
HI	5/1/2014	HI	3/5/2015	HI	9/23/2016	HI	3/22/2017
HI	8/27/2018	HI	4/5/2019	HI	10/24/2019	HI	10/22/2020
HI	4/1/2021	HI	7/5/2021	HI	10/25/2022	HI	9/12/2023
HI	1/10/2025	HI	7/21/2025	IA	5/2/2014	IA	1/27/2015
IA	3/25/2015	IA	7/28/2015	IA	9/5/2015	IA	10/18/2016
IA	1/31/2017	IA	6/13/2017	IA	8/25/2018	IA	8/27/2018
IA	3/6/2019	IA	5/10/2019	IA	11/26/2019	IA	1/9/2020
IA	3/3/2020	IA	4/23/2020	IA	8/6/2020	IA	10/1/2020
State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date

State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date
IA	10/22/2020	IA	3/4/2021	IA	7/7/2021	IA	11/3/2021
IA	10/18/2022	IA	4/6/2023	IA	10/3/2024	IA	4/24/2025
ID	3/20/2014	ID	2/23/2015	ID	7/29/2015	ID	3/2/2016
ID	5/31/2016	ID	10/5/2016	ID	3/20/2017	ID	7/25/2017
ID	8/25/2017	ID	8/21/2018	ID	8/27/2018	ID	3/4/2019
ID	5/3/2019	ID	7/10/2019	ID	2/24/2020	ID	8/14/2020
ID	10/4/2020	ID	3/16/2021	ID	7/5/2021	ID	11/3/2021
ID	11/17/2021	ID	10/15/2022	ID	9/18/2023	ID	2/11/2025
ID	7/17/2025	IL	3/16/2014	IL	1/8/2015	IL	3/2/2015
IL	9/23/2016	IL	3/17/2017	IL	9/27/2017	IL	7/28/2018
IL	8/27/2018	IL	2/21/2019	IL	5/14/2019	IL	3/3/2020
IL	10/1/2020	IL	3/5/2021	IL	7/16/2021	IL	10/19/2022
IL	3/18/2023	IL	9/3/2024	IL	5/10/2025	IN	3/27/2014
IN	5/6/2015	IN	7/29/2015	IN	8/7/2015	IN	2/7/2016
IN	9/23/2016	IN	4/7/2017	IN	7/12/2017	IN	10/12/2017
IN	3/16/2018	IN	9/1/2018	IN	10/17/2018	IN	2/13/2019
IN	5/3/2019	IN	8/1/2019	IN	1/22/2020	IN	2/27/2020
IN	5/7/2020	IN	8/24/2020	IN	10/1/2020	IN	1/15/2021
IN	7/8/2021	IN	10/8/2022	IN	3/27/2023	IN	2/18/2025
IN	10/2/2025	KS	1/1/2013	KS	3/16/2014	KS	2/26/2015
KS	7/29/2015	KS	12/11/2015	KS	9/23/2016	KS	2/16/2017
KS	6/19/2017	KS	7/9/2018	KS	1/31/2019	KS	5/3/2019
KS	6/11/2019	KS	2/24/2020	KS	3/18/2020	KS	7/15/2020
KS	3/16/2021	KS	8/24/2021	KS	11/28/2022	KS	9/18/2023
KS	10/3/2024	KS	10/22/2024	KS	8/13/2025	KY	3/19/2014
KY	3/5/2015	KY	7/29/2015	KY	12/12/2015	KY	2/21/2016
KY	9/23/2016	KY	3/3/2017	KY	6/23/2017	KY	5/2/2018
KY	9/29/2018	KY	5/2/2019	KY	5/10/2019	KY	11/18/2019
KY	2/26/2020	KY	8/14/2020	KY	9/14/2020	KY	10/1/2020
KY	5/11/2021	KY	11/3/2021	KY	12/8/2021	KY	10/11/2022
KY	9/6/2023	KY	4/10/2025	KY	10/20/2025	LA	3/20/2014
LA	2/23/2015	LA	5/17/2015	LA	7/29/2015	LA	12/12/2015
LA	1/29/2016	LA	6/9/2016	LA	9/23/2016	LA	2/14/2017
LA	7/17/2017	LA	10/31/2017	LA	2/17/2018	LA	6/25/2018
LA	1/15/2019	LA	5/15/2019	LA	9/24/2019	LA	12/11/2019
LA	2/27/2020	LA	8/14/2020	LA	10/18/2020	LA	1/22/2021
LA	7/7/2021	LA	11/3/2021	LA	6/20/2023	LA	10/3/2024
LA	12/16/2024	MA	1/1/2013	MA	3/16/2014	MA	4/2/2015
MA	12/12/2015	MA	2/26/2016	MA	9/28/2016	MA	4/11/2017
State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date

State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date
MA	10/17/2017	MA	5/11/2018	MA	1/18/2019	MA	2/14/2019
MA	5/10/2019	MA	8/15/2019	MA	2/19/2020	MA	5/29/2020
MA	9/28/2020	MA	1/19/2021	MA	7/8/2021	MA	12/19/2021
MA	9/12/2023	MA	10/4/2024	MA	2/10/2025	MA	7/3/2025
MD	3/26/2014	MD	2/25/2015	MD	7/29/2015	MD	12/12/2015
MD	10/3/2016	MD	1/20/2017	MD	6/9/2017	MD	9/7/2017
MD	2/22/2018	MD	12/14/2018	MD	5/10/2019	MD	6/20/2019
MD	12/17/2019	MD	2/28/2020	MD	5/7/2020	MD	8/21/2020
MD	10/1/2020	MD	2/15/2021	MD	7/5/2021	MD	11/3/2021
MD	12/17/2021	MD	10/19/2022	MD	9/10/2023	MD	1/10/2025
MD	6/4/2025	ME	3/20/2014	ME	4/29/2015	ME	7/29/2015
ME	12/12/2015	ME	10/5/2016	ME	4/7/2017	ME	11/1/2017
ME	4/28/2018	ME	9/26/2018	ME	5/3/2019	ME	7/17/2019
ME	2/24/2020	ME	6/18/2020	ME	9/29/2020	ME	10/1/2020
ME	5/28/2021	ME	7/5/2021	ME	11/3/2021	ME	6/7/2023
ME	2/5/2025	ME	10/8/2025	MI	3/17/2014	MI	2/28/2015
MI	12/11/2015	MI	9/28/2016	MI	2/21/2017	MI	7/17/2018
MI	10/1/2018	MI	3/22/2019	MI	5/13/2019	MI	8/30/2019
MI	3/2/2020	MI	8/14/2020	MI	9/20/2020	MI	10/1/2020
MI	1/30/2021	MI	11/3/2021	MI	1/5/2022	MI	10/6/2022
MI	4/21/2023	MI	6/26/2024	MI	10/2/2024	MI	5/10/2025
MN	3/17/2014	MN	3/3/2015	MN	7/31/2015	MN	12/12/2015
MN	2/25/2016	MN	10/3/2016	MN	3/10/2017	MN	7/22/2017
MN	7/31/2018	MN	8/27/2018	MN	4/2/2019	MN	5/10/2019
MN	10/3/2019	MN	2/25/2020	MN	8/14/2020	MN	10/1/2020
MN	10/19/2020	MN	2/14/2021	MN	7/23/2021	MN	10/27/2022
MN	9/12/2023	MN	10/3/2024	MN	2/14/2025	MN	5/14/2025
MO	1/1/2013	MO	3/19/2014	MO	3/2/2015	MO	7/30/2015
MO	9/3/2015	MO	7/1/2016	MO	9/28/2016	MO	12/1/2016
MO	2/8/2017	MO	6/7/2017	MO	6/28/2018	MO	10/5/2018
MO	2/16/2019	MO	5/10/2019	MO	6/3/2019	MO	2/20/2020
MO	6/23/2020	MO	9/22/2020	MO	2/11/2021	MO	11/19/2022
MO	5/10/2023	MO	2/1/2025	MO	5/20/2025	MS	1/1/2013
MS	3/17/2014	MS	3/17/2015	MS	7/29/2015	MS	12/13/2015
MS	2/19/2016	MS	10/3/2016	MS	3/7/2017	MS	7/27/2017
MS	3/23/2018	MS	9/18/2018	MS	3/11/2019	MS	5/12/2019
MS	8/8/2019	MS	3/3/2020	MS	6/9/2020	MS	8/17/2020
MS	10/1/2020	MS	3/23/2021	MS	11/3/2021	MS	10/27/2022
MS	9/19/2023	MS	1/10/2025	MS	6/10/2025	MT	3/18/2014
State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date

State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date
MT	3/27/2015	MT	7/30/2015	MT	12/13/2015	MT	10/3/2016
MT	1/25/2017	MT	7/14/2017	MT	8/3/2018	MT	2/7/2019
MT	5/3/2019	MT	6/13/2019	MT	2/29/2020	MT	3/14/2020
MT	8/19/2020	MT	10/1/2020	MT	12/14/2020	MT	11/3/2021
MT	11/22/2021	MT	12/1/2022	MT	5/18/2023	MT	10/4/2024
MT	6/23/2025	NC	3/27/2014	NC	7/29/2015	NC	5/26/2016
NC	10/19/2016	NC	1/12/2017	NC	5/24/2017	NC	6/28/2018
NC	2/1/2019	NC	5/10/2019	NC	8/14/2020	NC	1/28/2021
NC	5/18/2021	NC	8/23/2022	NC	2/15/2023	NC	6/26/2024
NC	1/10/2025	ND	3/17/2014	ND	4/15/2015	ND	7/31/2015
ND	12/13/2015	ND	9/28/2016	ND	2/9/2017	ND	3/21/2018
ND	9/8/2018	ND	3/22/2019	ND	5/13/2019	ND	10/14/2019
ND	2/28/2020	ND	8/15/2020	ND	9/18/2020	ND	10/1/2020
ND	3/18/2021	ND	7/5/2021	ND	11/3/2021	ND	10/14/2022
ND	9/19/2023	ND	2/7/2025	ND	7/9/2025	NE	3/18/2014
NE	3/25/2015	NE	7/29/2015	NE	12/13/2015	NE	7/2/2016
NE	10/3/2016	NE	1/13/2017	NE	5/25/2017	NE	7/11/2018
NE	1/10/2019	NE	5/3/2019	NE	11/26/2019	NE	2/20/2020
NE	3/18/2020	NE	6/27/2020	NE	10/1/2020	NE	1/20/2021
NE	7/30/2021	NE	11/3/2021	NE	10/4/2022	NE	4/1/2023
NE	12/10/2024	NE	5/15/2025	NH	3/17/2014	NH	10/13/2014
NH	3/20/2015	NH	7/29/2015	NH	9/11/2015	NH	12/13/2015
NH	6/27/2016	NH	10/3/2016	NH	2/17/2018	NH	8/15/2018
NH	8/27/2018	NH	4/10/2019	NH	5/13/2019	NH	10/22/2019
NH	1/5/2020	NH	3/3/2020	NH	7/30/2020	NH	10/1/2020
NH	3/25/2021	NH	7/5/2021	NH	6/16/2023	NH	10/4/2024
NH	3/28/2025	NH	10/14/2025	NJ	4/22/2014	NJ	2/25/2015
NJ	7/30/2015	NJ	12/12/2015	NJ	5/23/2016	NJ	9/29/2016
NJ	3/31/2017	NJ	4/25/2017	NJ	9/20/2017	NJ	3/6/2018
NJ	10/16/2018	NJ	3/1/2019	NJ	5/13/2019	NJ	9/30/2019
NJ	2/26/2020	NJ	5/12/2020	NJ	6/18/2020	NJ	9/9/2020
NJ	10/1/2020	NJ	3/11/2021	NJ	7/11/2021	NJ	8/26/2021
NJ	11/3/2021	NJ	1/5/2022	NJ	8/22/2022	NJ	1/31/2023
NJ	1/15/2025	NJ	3/24/2025	NM	3/20/2014	NM	3/19/2015
NM	7/29/2015	NM	12/13/2015	NM	3/12/2016	NM	9/28/2016
NM	2/8/2017	NM	8/12/2017	NM	10/26/2017	NM	8/21/2018
NM	11/7/2018	NM	2/22/2019	NM	5/3/2019	NM	6/17/2019
NM	6/24/2019	NM	11/9/2019	NM	2/24/2020	NM	4/15/2020
NM	8/24/2020	NM	10/1/2020	NM	2/25/2021	NM	7/9/2021
State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date

State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date
NM	11/3/2021	NM	1/4/2022	NM	11/28/2022	NM	9/4/2023
NM	1/31/2025	NM	10/10/2025	NV	3/14/2014	NV	1/30/2015
NV	5/28/2015	NV	7/29/2015	NV	12/13/2015	NV	10/7/2016
NV	1/13/2017	NV	5/24/2017	NV	11/24/2017	NV	8/10/2018
NV	1/23/2019	NV	5/3/2019	NV	6/4/2019	NV	1/11/2020
NV	2/22/2020	NV	4/22/2020	NV	8/5/2020	NV	10/1/2020
NV	12/17/2020	NV	6/13/2021	NV	7/7/2021	NV	11/3/2021
NV	8/25/2022	NV	2/1/2023	NV	9/5/2024	NV	2/28/2025
NY	4/15/2014	NY	1/15/2015	NY	3/25/2015	NY	7/28/2015
NY	2/23/2016	NY	10/23/2016	NY	3/13/2017	NY	6/17/2017
NY	2/16/2018	NY	8/14/2018	NY	2/27/2019	NY	7/25/2019
NY	8/24/2020	NY	10/15/2020	NY	3/15/2021	NY	11/3/2021
NY	8/30/2022	NY	3/15/2023	NY	10/15/2024	NY	5/10/2025
OH	3/17/2014	OH	1/8/2015	OH	7/29/2015	OH	2/3/2016
OH	5/22/2016	OH	10/5/2016	OH	1/9/2017	OH	6/30/2017
OH	2/17/2018	OH	6/28/2018	OH	1/22/2019	OH	5/22/2019
OH	5/3/2020	OH	6/26/2020	OH	1/7/2021	OH	5/28/2021
OH	8/25/2022	OH	1/14/2023	OH	10/4/2024	OH	1/29/2025
OK	3/17/2014	OK	3/26/2015	OK	7/29/2015	OK	12/13/2015
OK	2/24/2016	OK	5/23/2016	OK	10/3/2016	OK	1/12/2017
OK	4/22/2017	OK	6/8/2017	OK	8/6/2018	OK	10/9/2018
OK	3/1/2019	OK	5/3/2019	OK	8/13/2019	OK	1/10/2020
OK	2/25/2020	OK	4/15/2020	OK	5/10/2020	OK	6/1/2020
OK	7/29/2020	OK	9/19/2020	OK	2/8/2021	OK	11/3/2021
OK	12/8/2021	OK	9/17/2022	OK	4/28/2023	OK	9/3/2024
OK	1/10/2025	OK	3/11/2025	OR	3/17/2014	OR	4/16/2015
OR	7/29/2015	OR	12/13/2015	OR	7/13/2016	OR	10/26/2016
OR	1/13/2017	OR	6/6/2017	OR	9/13/2017	OR	7/26/2018
OR	8/27/2018	OR	2/24/2019	OR	5/8/2019	OR	6/25/2019
OR	1/7/2020	OR	2/25/2020	OR	7/17/2020	OR	10/1/2020
OR	2/5/2021	OR	7/9/2021	OR	11/3/2021	OR	12/1/2022
OR	5/16/2023	OR	1/10/2025	OR	5/10/2025	PA	5/1/2014
PA	5/1/2015	PA	7/29/2015	PA	8/11/2015	PA	3/8/2016
PA	7/13/2016	PA	2/14/2017	PA	8/4/2017	PA	2/20/2018
PA	8/22/2018	PA	8/24/2018	PA	2/15/2019	PA	8/22/2019
PA	7/2/2020	PA	10/1/2020	PA	2/17/2021	PA	7/16/2021
PA	8/30/2022	PA	2/2/2023	PA	9/6/2024	PA	5/10/2025
RI	3/19/2014	RI	3/6/2015	RI	7/29/2015	RI	12/13/2015
RI	10/3/2016	RI	1/18/2017	RI	6/8/2017	RI	7/17/2018
State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date

State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date
RI	8/27/2018	RI	3/15/2019	RI	5/10/2019	RI	8/16/2019
RI	12/4/2019	RI	2/28/2020	RI	8/15/2020	RI	10/1/2020
RI	3/16/2021	RI	7/7/2021	RI	9/20/2023	RI	9/5/2024
RI	5/10/2025	SC	3/18/2014	SC	10/22/2014	SC	4/9/2015
SC	10/31/2015	SC	2/11/2016	SC	7/1/2016	SC	10/3/2016
SC	2/24/2017	SC	8/31/2017	SC	4/4/2018	SC	9/11/2018
SC	3/12/2019	SC	9/5/2019	SC	12/18/2019	SC	2/21/2020
SC	6/4/2020	SC	9/16/2020	SC	10/1/2020	SC	4/16/2021
SC	5/21/2021	SC	11/3/2021	SC	11/11/2022	SC	5/11/2023
SC	9/5/2024	SC	10/4/2024	SC	4/7/2025	SD	3/20/2014
SD	3/13/2015	SD	7/29/2015	SD	10/6/2015	SD	12/13/2015
SD	2/15/2016	SD	9/28/2016	SD	2/20/2017	SD	6/16/2017
SD	6/8/2018	SD	1/14/2019	SD	5/11/2019	SD	5/23/2019
SD	11/26/2019	SD	2/18/2020	SD	2/25/2020	SD	8/19/2020
SD	10/1/2020	SD	1/22/2021	SD	7/6/2021	SD	9/27/2022
SD	9/20/2023	SD	1/10/2025	SD	5/27/2025	TN	3/18/2014
TN	2/23/2015	TN	7/30/2015	TN	9/11/2015	TN	10/2/2016
TN	2/17/2017	TN	7/6/2017	TN	7/19/2018	TN	1/30/2019
TN	5/10/2019	TN	7/5/2019	TN	2/20/2020	TN	3/31/2020
TN	5/20/2020	TN	10/1/2020	TN	10/18/2020	TN	3/29/2021
TN	7/19/2021	TN	10/22/2022	TN	6/13/2023	TN	2/4/2025
TN	6/25/2025	TX	3/19/2014	TX	11/8/2014	TX	4/15/2015
TX	7/31/2015	TX	5/22/2016	TX	9/30/2016	TX	3/12/2017
TX	8/21/2017	TX	6/29/2018	TX	2/24/2019	TX	5/24/2019
TX	5/24/2020	TX	3/25/2021	TX	6/12/2021	TX	5/7/2022
TX	3/12/2023	TX	7/11/2024	TX	3/1/2025	UT	3/20/2014
UT	3/6/2015	UT	7/29/2015	UT	8/7/2015	UT	12/13/2015
UT	10/3/2016	UT	1/25/2017	UT	6/2/2017	UT	8/22/2018
UT	8/27/2018	UT	3/7/2019	UT	5/3/2019	UT	8/3/2019
UT	2/27/2020	UT	4/7/2020	UT	5/10/2020	UT	8/11/2020
UT	9/30/2020	UT	3/26/2021	UT	7/8/2021	UT	11/3/2021
UT	10/19/2022	UT	6/24/2023	UT	1/10/2025	UT	8/19/2025
VA	3/14/2014	VA	4/18/2015	VA	7/31/2015	VA	9/30/2015
VA	12/14/2015	VA	2/25/2016	VA	9/28/2016	VA	3/29/2017
VA	10/7/2017	VA	2/17/2018	VA	8/27/2018	VA	8/30/2018
VA	2/25/2019	VA	5/11/2019	VA	6/17/2019	VA	9/16/2019
VA	3/1/2020	VA	8/15/2020	VA	9/9/2020	VA	10/1/2020
VA	5/28/2021	VA	7/10/2021	VA	11/3/2021	VA	1/4/2022
VA	9/7/2022	VA	9/9/2023	VA	1/30/2025	VA	6/3/2025
State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date

State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date
VT	3/19/2014	VT	3/20/2015	VT	7/31/2015	VT	12/13/2015
VT	2/11/2016	VT	9/21/2016	VT	2/14/2017	VT	5/31/2017
VT	6/12/2017	VT	6/11/2018	VT	8/27/2018	VT	3/8/2019
VT	5/12/2019	VT	8/22/2019	VT	2/12/2020	VT	2/27/2020
VT	8/3/2020	VT	9/11/2020	VT	5/28/2021	VT	7/4/2021
VT	11/3/2021	VT	12/5/2022	VT	6/6/2023	VT	1/10/2025
VT	5/28/2025	WA	3/19/2014	WA	5/5/2015	WA	7/29/2015
WA	9/10/2015	WA	12/14/2015	WA	1/24/2016	WA	10/28/2016
WA	12/23/2016	WA	5/24/2017	WA	9/16/2017	WA	12/19/2017
WA	2/17/2018	WA	7/15/2018	WA	1/8/2019	WA	5/12/2019
WA	5/22/2019	WA	10/15/2019	WA	12/20/2019	WA	3/3/2020
WA	4/20/2020	WA	5/10/2020	WA	10/1/2020	WA	12/9/2020
WA	7/22/2021	WA	12/5/2022	WA	1/17/2023	WA	6/26/2024
WA	10/7/2024	WA	2/4/2025	WI	3/18/2014	WI	3/3/2015
WI	7/31/2015	WI	9/8/2015	WI	10/3/2016	WI	3/30/2017
WI	6/2/2018	WI	2/1/2019	WI	5/10/2019	WI	6/23/2019
WI	3/3/2020	WI	3/21/2020	WI	5/10/2020	WI	5/31/2020
WI	9/29/2020	WI	10/1/2020	WI	2/24/2021	WI	11/3/2021
WI	12/14/2022	WI	4/28/2023	WI	10/2/2024	WI	5/16/2025
WV	4/16/2014	WV	3/16/2015	WV	7/29/2015	WV	9/10/2015
WV	12/14/2015	WV	9/28/2016	WV	4/3/2017	WV	9/20/2017
WV	8/14/2018	WV	11/6/2018	WV	3/22/2019	WV	5/12/2019
WV	9/5/2019	WV	2/27/2020	WV	3/29/2020	WV	8/15/2020
WV	10/6/2020	WV	3/11/2021	WV	7/9/2021	WV	9/18/2023
WV	1/10/2025	WV	5/10/2025	WY	3/19/2014	WY	3/30/2015
WY	7/29/2015	WY	8/6/2015	WY	12/13/2015	WY	9/28/2016
WY	2/2/2017	WY	7/17/2017	WY	7/26/2018	WY	8/27/2018
WY	4/2/2019	WY	5/12/2019	WY	9/6/2019	WY	3/2/2020
WY	8/14/2020	WY	10/9/2020	WY	1/13/2021	WY	7/6/2021
WY	10/21/2022	WY	9/19/2023	WY	7/9/2025		
State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date	State	File Date

A.3 Election Workload and Election Official Turnover Descriptive Statistics

Table A.3: Descriptive Statistics

Variable	N	Jurisdictions	Mean	SD	Min	Max
Workload						
Elections administered, criteria method	56166	5106	1.98	1.26	0	11.00
excluding local elections	56166	5106	1.78	1.17	0	10.00
Elections administered, stayer method	69395	6311	2.20	1.32	0	15.00
excluding local elections	69395	6311	2.04	1.26	0	11.00
Elections administered, manual collection	3693	353	2.85	1.59	0	14.00
Votes cast per VAP, criteria method	68117	6193	0.63	0.49	0	3.94
excluding local elections	68117	6193	0.60	0.49	0	3.94
Votes cast per VAP, stayer method	67588	6147	0.32	0.26	0	2.32
excluding local elections	67588	6147	0.31	0.26	0	2.32
Outcome						
New local election official (two-year turnover)	25410	5082	0.21	0.41	0	1.00

The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014-2024. Workload statistics cover all years and treat each jurisdiction equally. Turnover is defined in even years only and is reported on the estimation sample of Table 3, column 1, weighted by the jurisdiction weight used in estimation (New York jurisdictions receive a weight of one-half because both election board co-chairs are coded as separate officials). The regressions use workload summed over two consecutive years, so the mean of each regressor is twice the annual mean reported here. Sample sizes differ across rows where a measure is unavailable for some jurisdiction-years: the manual collection covers the most populous counties only, and jurisdictions missing voting-age population in any year are dropped from the votes-per-VAP measures.

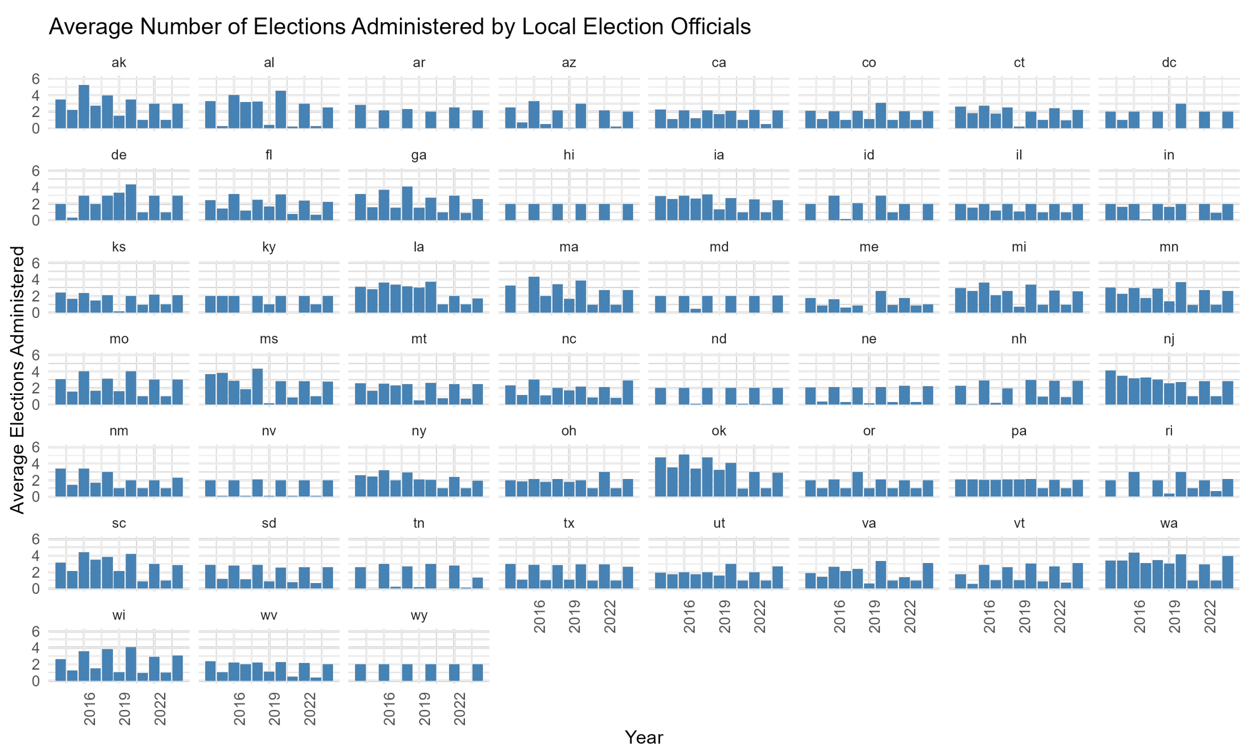
A.4 Additional Election Workload Descriptive Figures

This section includes a range of additional county- and state-level visualizations of Election workload, as well as comparisons across calculation methods.

A.4.1 State-Year Workload Averages

Figure A.1 shows election date workloads at the state-year level. While states tend to have more election dates in even years, the difference is surprisingly not large in most states. Additionally, there is no overall trend of increasing or decreasing workloads.

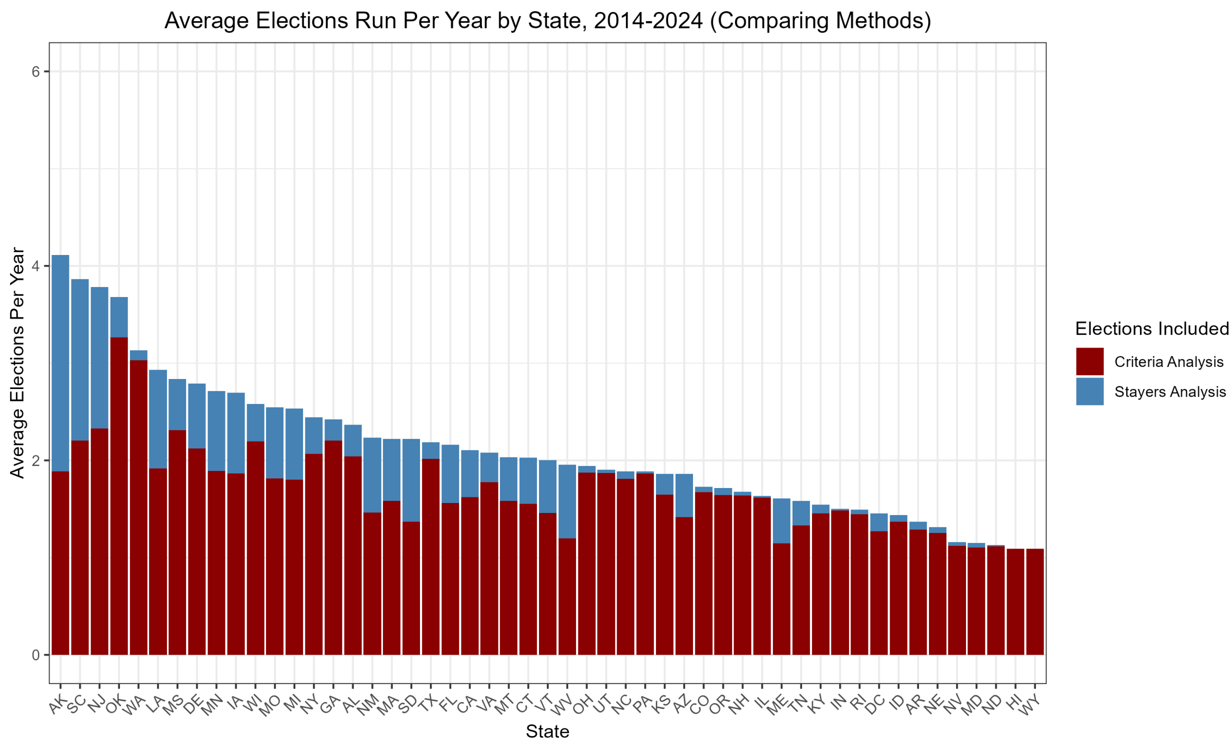
Figure A.1: **Average Number of Elections Run Per Year by Local Election Officials, Over Time Comparison**. This figure displays the average number of elections administered each year by each state's local election officials, calculated using the criteria method with nationwide voter file data from L2 and spanning 2014–2024.



A.4.2 Comparison of Election Workload Methods

Figure A.2 shows the average number of elections administered in each state, comparing the criteria and stayer methods of calculation. The criteria method is almost always the more conservative measure of election workload.

Figure A.2: **Average Number of Elections Run Per Year by Local Election Officials, 2014–2024 (Comparing Methods)**. This figure displays the average number of elections administered each year by each state's local election officials between 2014 and 2024. The blue bars use the stayers method to calculate election date workload. The red bars use the criteria method for calculating workload.



A.4.3 State-Level Workload Maps

Figure A.3 is a map of the average number of yearly election dates in each jurisdiction, averaged to the state level and using the criteria method to calculate workload. Figure A.4 shows snapshots of the state-level workload averages in even years between 2014 and 2024.

Figure A.3: **Map of Average Number of Election Dates in Each State, 2014–2024**. This map displays the average number of elections administered each year by each state's local election officials between 2014 and 2024 using the criteria method to calculate workload.

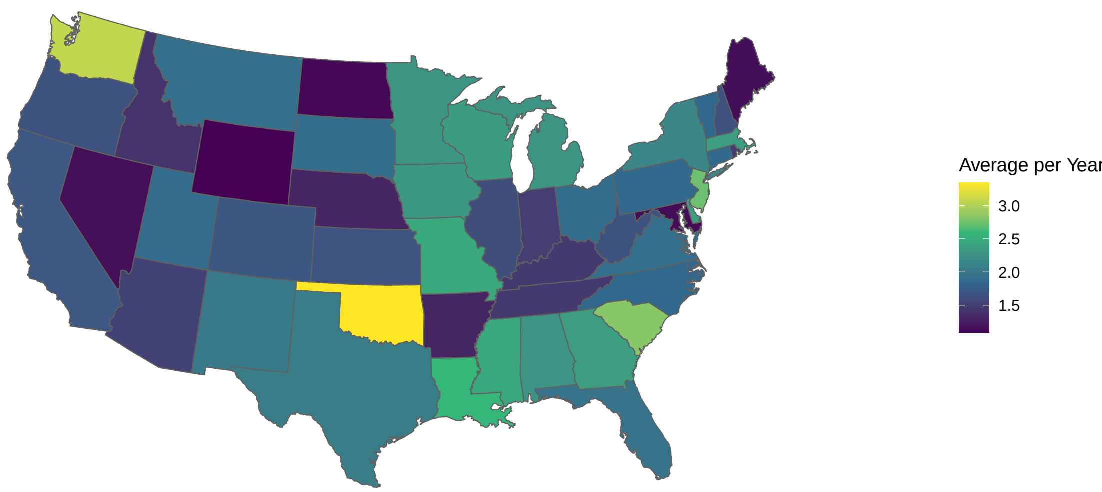
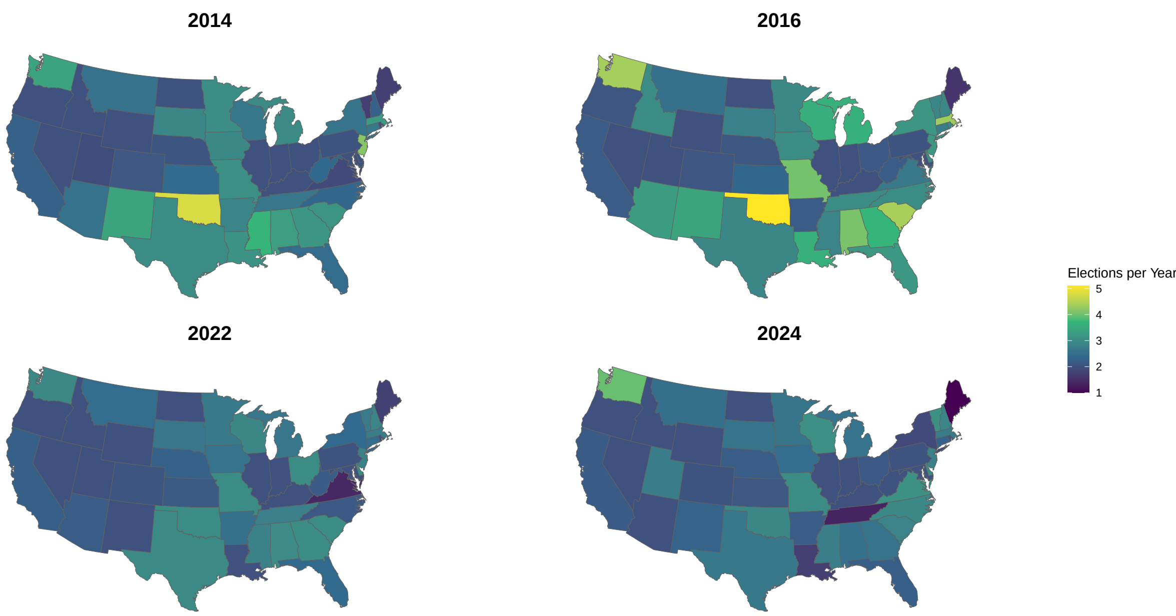


Figure A.4: **Map of Average Number of Elections Run in Each State, 2014–2024**. This map displays the average number of elections administered each year by each state's local election officials between 2014 and 2024, averaged to the state level and using the criteria method to calculate workload.



A.4.4 Alternative County-Level Workload Maps

Figure A.5 shows the average number of elections administered in each county election jurisdiction, calculated using the stayer method instead of the criteria method. The patterns of high and low workloads are broadly similar to those found in the Figure 1 using the criteria method. In general, the stayer method produces higher average estimates of Election Date workloads. Figure A.6 shows the average number of elections administered in each county election jurisdiction, calculated using the criteria method but excluding elections labeled by L2 as local or municipal elections. Figure A.7 shows overtime jurisdiction-level changes in the number of election dates administered each year similar to Figure 2 in the main analysis, instead using the stayer method of workload calculation.

Figure A.5: **Map of Average Number of Elections Run Per Year by Local Election Officials using Stayer Method, 2014–2024**. This figure displays the average number of yearly elections administered by each county's local election officials between 2014 and 2024, calculated using the stayer method with nationwide voter file data from L2 spanning 2014–2024.

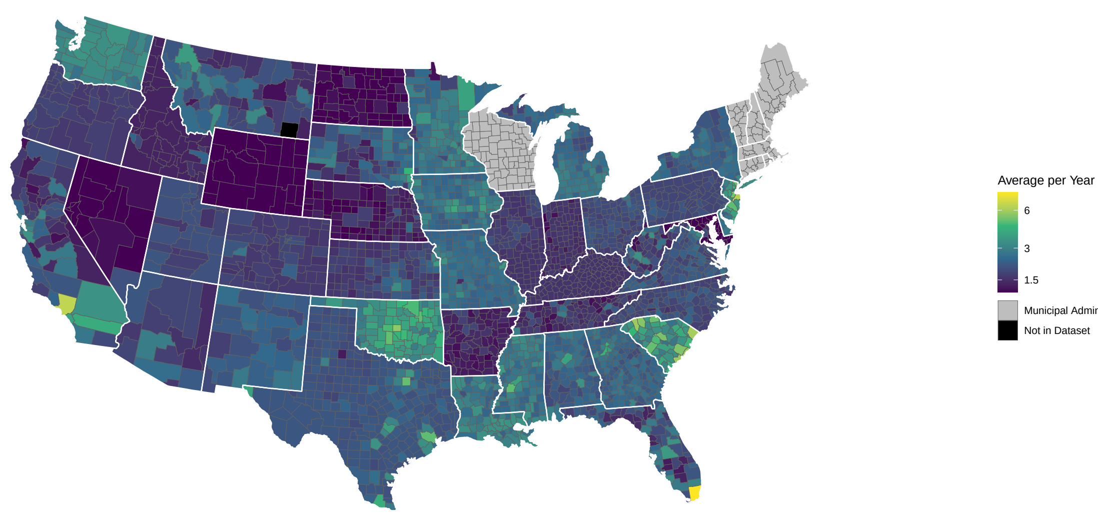


Figure A.6: **Map of Average Number of Elections Run Per Year by Local Election Officials Excluding Local Elections, 2014–2024**. This figure displays the average number of yearly elections administered by each county's local election officials between 2014 and 2024, calculated using the criteria method with nationwide voter file data from L2 spanning 2014–2024. Elections that L2 labels as "Local or Municipal" are excluded from this analysis.

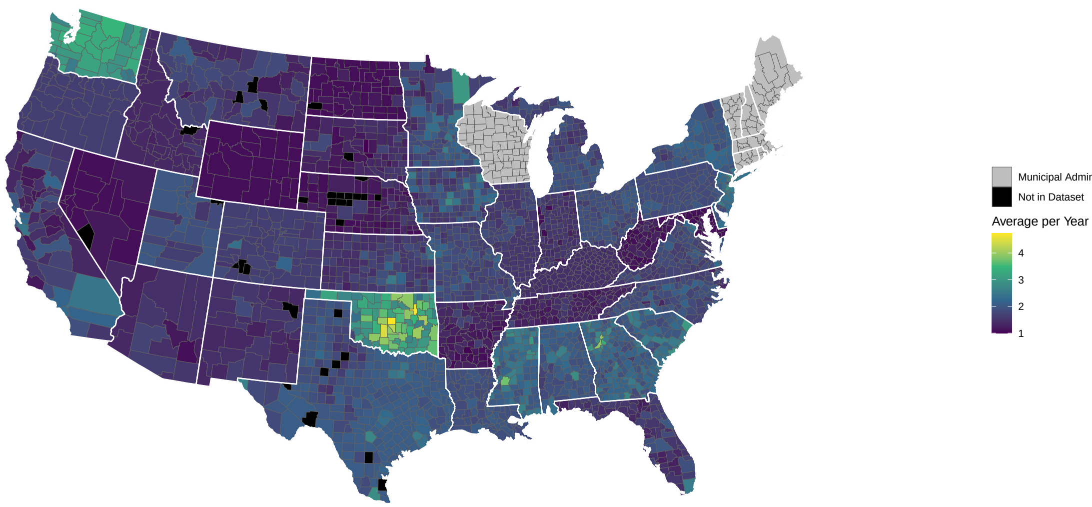
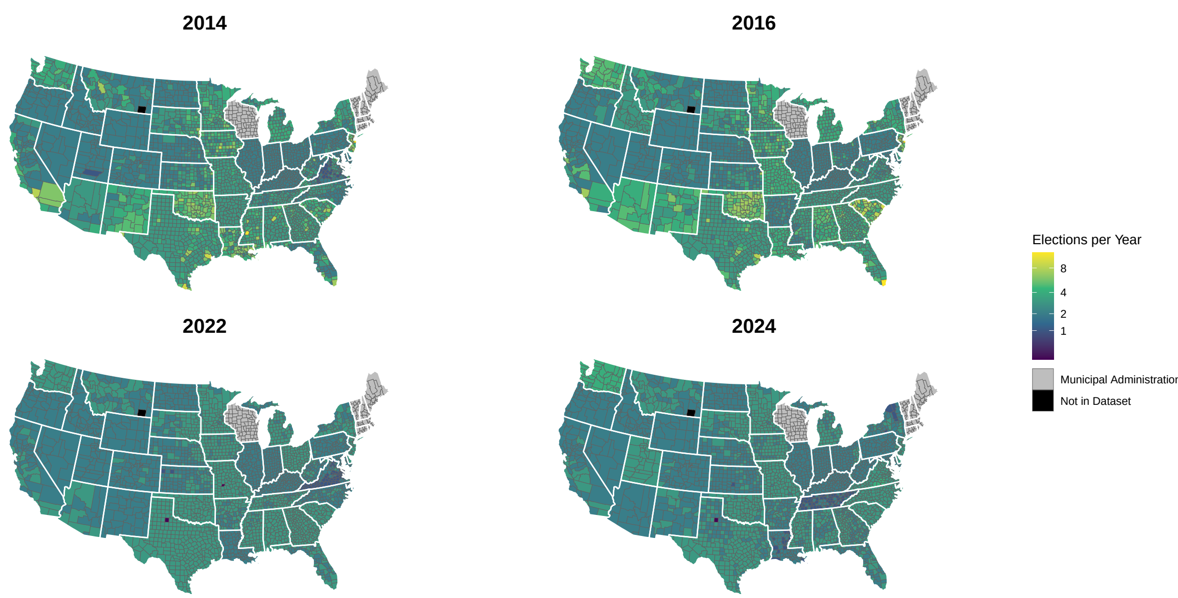


Figure A.7: **Map of Elections Run Each Year using Stayer Method, 2014–2024**. This figure displays the number of Election Days in each jurisdiction in 2014, 2016, 2022, and 2024, calculated using the stayer method with nationwide voter file data from L2.



A.5 Additional Cross-Sectional Tests of the Relationship Between Workload and Turnover

Tables 1 and 2 in the main paper show the results of the cross-sectional relationship between elections administered and incidents of turnover when state fixed effects are included. This means comparisons were made leveraging variation in workload and turnover across jurisdictions within the same state. Tables A.4 and A.5 are identical to the tables in the main table, but no longer include state fixed effects. This means that comparisons are made between jurisdictions across the entire country. The results are similar: some point estimates are positive, some are negative, and none indicate an effect that is statistically distinguishable from zero.

Table A.4: **Relationship Between Election Workload and Turnover, 2014–2024**

	Total Number of Local Election Officials			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Total Elections Administered	-0.003	0.003	-0.004	0.001
	(0.006)	(0.007)	(0.005)	(0.005)
Observations	5,082	5,082	6,259	6,259
Outcome Mean	2.04	2.04	2.03	2.03
State FEs	No	No	No	No
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by state in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction, 2014–2024.

Table A.5: **Relationship Between Election Workload and Turnover, 2014–2024**

	Total Number of Local Election Officials			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Total Votes Per VAP	0.001	0.007	0.003	0.008
	(0.012)	(0.011)	(0.009)	(0.009)
Observations	6,248	6,248	6,199	6,199
Outcome Mean	2.03	2.03	2.04	2.04
State FEs	No	No	No	No
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by state in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction, 2014–2024. Jurisdictions where voting-age population is unavailable are excluded from votes-per-VAP specifications.

A.6 Additional Difference-in-Differences Tests of the Relationship Between Workload and Turnover

This section includes regressions testing alternative specifications of the relationship between workload and turnover, all employing at the minimum jurisdiction and year fixed effects. Table A.9 measures workload over a four-year period. Table A.10 measures workload as the average of the first and second lag of Election Days administered, and Table A.11 measures workload as the second and third lag of Election Days administered. Table A.12 subsets the dataset to jurisdictions in states with a high level of responsibility for administering municipal elections. Table A.13 subsets the dataset to jurisdictions according to the degree of authority the coded election official has in administering elections. Table A.14 subsets the dataset to counties. Tables A.15 and A.16 use 2 and 4 year definitions of workload, respectively, and employ state fixed effects instead of state-by-year fixed effects. Table A.17 uses workload data calculated by manually collecting Election Dates from the 400 most populous counties' election websites.

I run additional robustness tests varying components of the main specification in column 1 of Table 3. Column 1 of Table A.6 repeats this specification. Column 2 conducts a placebo test using the number elections conducted in the two-year period after turnover is measured. The result is again a precisely estimated null effect. Column 3 clusters standard errors by state rather than jurisdiction. Columns 4 and 5 test the robustness of the results to a temporal change in the L2 voter file's treatment of off-cycle elections. After 2020, L2 right-censors off-cycle elections to one of each type a year (local, special, etc.). The results across all specifications continue to be statistically indistinguishable from zero.

Table A.7 tests delayed effects of heightened election administration workload on turnover, up to four years after an increase in workload. No individual period effect is statistically significant, nor is the combined joint Wald test ($p = 0.58$). Finally, I separate election workload into binned coefficients of the number of elections administered over the past two years, with 3 elections administered the reference category. If anything, these regressions show that turnover is higher when there are 2 or fewer Election Days, but none of the binned coefficients are statistically significant. Again, a joint Wald test shows no relationship between number of elections administered and election official turnover (p = 0.56).

Across most specifications, I do not identify a positive relationship between higher workloads and more turnover. While six tests do result in a statistically significant positive relationship, these are the least causally credible specifications, and one results in a significant relationship in the opposite direction. The sum total of evidence is that there is no relationship between workload and turnover.

Table A.6: **Additional Robustness Tests of the Main Estimate**

	2-Year Turnover				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Elections over Past 2 Years	-0.003	0.002	-0.003	-0.008	0.001
	(0.004)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.016)
Jurisdictions	5,082	5,082	5,082	5,082	5,082
Years	5	4	5	3	2
Observations	25,410	20,328	25,410	15,246	10,164
Outcome Mean	0.21	0.20	0.21	0.19	0.24
Regressor	Contemp	Two-year lead	Contemp	Contemp	Contemp
Clustering	Jurisdiction	Jurisdiction	State	Jurisdiction	Jurisdiction
Window	2016–2024	2016–2022	2016–2024	2016–2020	2022–2024
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Column (1) reproduces the main specification, with a contemporaneous regressor. Column (2) replaces the contemporaneous regressor with its two-year lead as a placebo. Column (3) clusters by state rather than jurisdiction. Columns (4) and (5) split the panel at the 2021 L2 recoding of off-cycle elections.

Table A.7: **Distributed Lag Specification**

	2-Year Turnover
	(1)
Elections Administered, t	0.007
	(0.007)
Elections Administered, $t-1$	0.005
	(0.005)
Elections Administered, $t-2$	0.006
	(0.005)
Joint test (p)	0.578
Observations	15,246
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes

Lags are in biennial periods, so $t-1$ is the two years prior to the contemporaneous window. Joint test is a Wald test of the nullity of all three coefficients. Sample is 2020–2024; the two lags drop 2016 and 2018. Standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses.

Table A.8: **Binned Dose-Response**

	2-Year Turnover
	(1)
$\leq$ 2 elections	0.015
	(0.014)
4 elections	-0.002
	(0.011)
5 elections	-0.017
	(0.015)
6+ elections	-0.011
	(0.016)
Joint test (p)	0.563
Observations	25,410
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes

Omitted category is three elections administered over the past two years. Joint test is a Wald test of the nullity of all four bin coefficients. Standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses.

Table A.9: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered over Past 4 Years	0.001	-0.000	-0.001	-0.004
	(0.003)	(0.004)	(0.003)	(0.003)
Jurisdictions	5,082	5,082	6,262	6,262
Years	4	4	4	4
Observations	20,328	20,328	25,040	25,040
Outcome Mean	0.22	0.22	0.22	0.22
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table A.10: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024 (Alt Lag Def)**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered over Past 2 Years	0.001	-0.001	-0.001	-0.003
	(0.004)	(0.005)	(0.003)	(0.004)
Jurisdictions	5,082	5,082	6,263	6,263
Years	5	5	5	5
Observations	25,410	25,410	31,301	31,301
Outcome Mean	0.21	0.21	0.21	0.21
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table A.11: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024 (Prior Lag Def)**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered in Prior 2 Years	0.002	0.000	0.001	-0.001
	(0.004)	(0.005)	(0.003)	(0.004)
Jurisdictions	5,082	5,082	6,263	6,263
Years	4	4	4	4
Observations	20,328	20,328	25,042	25,042
Outcome Mean	0.22	0.22	0.22	0.22
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table A.12: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024 (High Municipal Responsibility)**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered over Past 2 Years	-0.002	-0.003	-0.005	-0.005
	(0.004)	(0.005)	(0.004)	(0.005)
Jurisdictions	3,745	3,745	4,911	4,911
Years	5	5	5	5
Observations	18,725	18,725	24,543	24,543
Outcome Mean	0.21	0.21	0.21	0.21
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table A.13: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover by Scope of Election Authority**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered over Past 2 Years	-0.003	-0.000	-0.002	-0.011
	(0.004)	(0.005)	(0.008)	(0.008)
Jurisdictions	5,082	3,773	1,449	1,248
Years	5	5	5	5
Observations	25,410	18,865	7,245	6,240
Outcome Mean	0.21	0.22	0.21	0.21
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Sample	All	Primary LEO	Strong LEO	Sole Authority
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Criteria	Criteria
Includes Local Elections	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table A.14: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024 (Excluding Municipalities)**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered over Past 2 Years	-0.006	-0.005	-0.006	-0.008
	(0.005)	(0.006)	(0.004)	(0.005)
Jurisdictions	2,988	2,988	3,019	3,019
Years	5	5	5	5
Observations	14,940	14,940	15,095	15,095
Outcome Mean	0.21	0.21	0.21	0.21
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table A.15: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024 (Year FE)**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered over Past 2 Years	0.008	0.015	0.004	0.008
	(0.003)	(0.003)	(0.002)	(0.003)
Jurisdictions	5,082	5,082	6,263	6,263
Years	5	5	5	5
Observations	25,410	25,410	31,303	31,303
Outcome Mean	0.21	0.21	0.21	0.21
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table A.16: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024 (Year FE)**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Elections Administered over Past 4 Years	0.004	0.008	0.002	0.006
	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)
Jurisdictions	5,082	5,082	6,262	6,262
Years	4	4	4	4
Observations	20,328	20,328	25,040	25,040
Outcome Mean	0.22	0.22	0.22	0.22
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Criteria	Criteria	Stayer	Stayer
Includes Local Elections	Yes	No	Yes	No

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024.

Table A.17: **Effect of Election Workload on Turnover, 2014–2024 (Manual Collection)**

	2-Year Turnover			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Prior Elections Administered	0.001	-0.003	-0.023	-0.015
	(0.010)	(0.008)	(0.009)	(0.010)
Jurisdictions	356	348	352	352
Years	5	4	5	4
Observations	1,686	1,327	1,673	1,336
Outcome Mean	0.23	0.23	0.23	0.23
Jurisdiction FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year x State FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Method	Manual	Manual	Manual	Manual
Lags	Past 2	Past 4	Past 2 Alt	Past 2 Prior
Includes Local Elections	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. The unit of analysis is the jurisdiction-year, 2014–2024. Jurisdiction counts reflect fixed-effect levels.

A.7 Consolidating Election Laws Table

Table A.18: Major State Laws Consolidating Local Election Dates

State	Bill	Enacted	Effective	Provision
Arizona	H-2826	05-14-2012	01-01-2014	Restricts candidate elections for political subdivisions (cities, towns, counties, school districts, community college districts, and other districts organized under state law, but not special taxing districts) to two even-numbered-year dates: the tenth Tuesday before the November general election, and the November general election itself. Recalls and special elections to fill vacancies remain permitted on four dates, including the second Tuesday in March and the third Tuesday in May. The consolidation provisions govern elections held in 2014 and after.
California	S-415	09-01-2015	01-01-2018	Prohibits a political subdivision (city, school district, community college district, or other district) from holding an election on a nonconcurrent date if doing so previously produced turnout at least 25% below the subdivision's average across the prior four statewide general elections. Special elections exempt.
Idaho	H-138	03-30-2023	07-01-2023	Requires all primary elections to be held on the third Tuesday in May of each even-numbered year.
Louisiana	H-563	06-20-2019	06-20-2019	For 2020 only, sets the first Saturday in April as the date for municipal and ward primaries, special primaries, and the presidential preference primary, and the fifth Saturday thereafter for municipal and ward general elections.
Nevada	A-50	06-12-2019	07-01-2021	Moves general city elections in covered population categories to the first Tuesday after the first Monday in November of even-numbered years, and moves city primaries from April to June for most cities.
Oklahoma	S-312	06-04-2015	01-01-2016	Restricts regular and special elections to fill elective office in counties, school districts, technology center districts, municipalities, and other subdivisions to five dates: the second Tuesday in February; the first Tuesday in April; any regularly scheduled statewide or federal election date in an even-numbered year; the second Tuesday in September of an odd-numbered year; and the second Tuesday in November of an odd-numbered year.
Oklahoma	S-347	05-05-2021	05-05-2021	Amends the 2015 date restrictions: adds fire protection districts to the covered subdivisions and adds a sixth permitted date, the second Tuesday in June of an odd-numbered year, for special elections to fill a vacancy.
Texas	S-2258	05-27-2023	09-01-2023	Permits a city of 9,000 or fewer residents, located predominantly in a county of less than 4,800 square miles and operating under a council-manager government, that holds its general election off the November uniform date to move that election to the November uniform date no later than December 31, 2024.

Notes: Provisions are condensed from statutory text. "Enacted" is the date of passage; "Effective" is the date the provision takes force.

A.8 Additional Election Official Attitudes Output

Table A.19: **Ballot Volume and Local Election Official Attitudes**

	Workload reasonable (1)	Cannot balance (2)	Lack of funding (3)	FTEs (4)	Sense of accomplish (5)	Job turnout (6)
Panel A: Year fixed effects						
Votes Per VAP over Past 2 Years	-0.093	0.135	-0.007	-0.017	0.073	-0.102
	(0.092)	(0.090)	(0.083)	(0.508)	(0.051)	(0.084)
Panel B: Year and jurisdiction fixed effects						
Votes Per VAP over Past 2 Years	-0.194	0.012	0.200	0.227	0.095	-0.225
	(0.251)	(0.274)	(0.260)	(0.778)	(0.134)	(0.216)
Jurisdictions	1,303	1,305	1,302	1,295	1,205	1,225
Years	3	3	3	3	3	3
Observations	1,813	1,814	1,814	1,806	1,636	1,652
Outcome Mean	3.12	2.55	2.76	6.06	4.50	3.81

Robust standard errors clustered by jurisdiction in parentheses. Data are the 2019, 2020, and 2023 EVIC Survey of Local Election Officials, merged to the jurisdiction-year panel. Individual controls are the total number of registered voters in the election jurisdiction and the age, gender, race, education, and salary of the election official. Columns 1–3 and 5–6 are 1–5 Likert scales ranging from "strongly disagree" to "strongly agree"; column 4 measures full-time equivalents.